ECC2K-130 on Commodity Hardware: A Measured Frobenius-Class Pollard Rho Campaign

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Abstract

ECC2K-130 is the Certicom Koblitz challenge $y^2 + xy = x^3 + 1$ over $\mathbb{F}_{2^{131}}$. It has been open since 1997, and the best published estimate puts it at $2^{60.9}$ iterations of a Frobenius-class Pollard rho. We report a campaign against it on hardware you can rent today, with every rate measured against a paired control. The field is built on a type-II optimal normal basis from a single generated golden model. On one RTX PRO 6000, sixteen paired optimisation steps take a packed CUDA client from a 0.85 billion-iterations-per-second bitsliced control to 14.64, the build the campaign ships; later builds of the same walk reach 15.88, and a table walk reaches 20.08, though only as a rate, not yet as a cost per solve. A VHDL engine runs at 8.25 billion iterations/s on one AWS F2 FPGA, inside its pre-board estimate of 5–12. We measure the walk constant instead of assuming it: the campaign's walk needs $2^{60.91}$–$2^{60.92}$ iterations, so the 2009 budget holds. A floor derived from the GPU's carry-less unit before any tuning rules out 28 billion iterations/s on one card. We then apply the same optimisations to Pollard rho on NIST P-256 and P-384 on the same GPU. Explicit carry chains, a wider shared inversion and the same refusal of register-cap trades take the walk from 1.075 to 1.632 billion iterations/s on P-256 (1.52×) and from 0.210 to 0.548 on P-384 (2.61×); the levers transfer, but their relative sizes do not. The campaign, at one distinguished point per $2^{28.41}$ iterations, has stored 486 million points and $2^{56.68}$ iterations, 5.4% of the expected work, without a collision; its fleet was reclaimed on 2026-09-18 and collection has been paused since 2026-10-07. Index calculus on the curve, priced in the same unit, comes out 10^7 times more expensive than rho, and the best measured point decomposition is 35–51 bits short of its budget. Every number is footnoted to a file in a public repository. None of this improves on the generic-group bound, and we do not claim that it does.

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1 Introduction

In 1997 Certicom published a list of elliptic-curve discrete logarithm challenges [11]. Three of them, ECC2K-95, ECC2K-108 and ECC2K-130, use the Koblitz curve $y^2 + xy = x^3 + 1$ over $\mathbb{F}_{2^{97}}$, $\mathbb{F}_{2^{109}}$ and $\mathbb{F}_{2^{131}}$ and ask for the k with $Q = [k]P$. Harley's group solved ECC2K-95 in 1998 [19] and ECC2K-108 in 2000. ECC2K-130 is still open. In 2009 a consortium of twenty authors published the arithmetic, the iteration function and per-platform throughput for an attack on it [2, 3, 9, 14], and estimated the work at $2^{60.9}$ iterations. That attack was never completed.

This paper describes a second attempt, built from scratch on hardware that did not exist in 2009. We tried to hold it to the standard the first attempt's reports set, and in places to a stricter one: every rate is paired against an adjacent control on the same machine, every target was written down before we tuned toward it, and every claim has a footnote naming the file in the repository that backs it. None of this improves on the generic-group bound, and we do not pretend otherwise. What we can report is the cost of one step, measured on GPUs, CPUs and an FPGA; the number of steps, measured on small curves of the same family and extrapolated; and a campaign that has walked $2^{56.7}$ of the $2^{60.9}$ iterations, most of it before its cloud fleet was taken away.

Along the way it became clear that most of what made the GPU client fast was not specific to binary fields. So we also carried the same optimisations over to Pollard rho on NIST P-256 and P-384, on the same card, to see which of them transfer.

Contributions.

- A code generator that builds every field routine from one symmetric-vector model of $\mathbb{F}_{2^{131}}$ and checks each routine before emitting it. On top of it sit a bitsliced backend at every word width from 64 to 512 lanes, a packed CUDA backend that uses the GPU's native carry-less products, and a VHDL engine, all of which write bit-for-bit compatible records (Sections 2 and 4).
- Three iteration functions on the $\langle \sigma, -1 \rangle$ classes, with walk constants measured on small Koblitz curves and extrapolated. The campaign's walk needs $2^{60.91}$–$2^{60.92}$ iterations. The table walk's fruitless cycles are measured, priced and repaired (Section 3).
- A GPU ledger of sixteen paired optimisation steps, taking one RTX PRO 6000 from 0.85 to 14.64 billion iterations/s for the campaign build, with later builds of the same walk at 15.44 and 15.88 and a table walk at 20.08 billion iterations/s (a rate whose cost per solve is not yet measured). We add a twelve-GPU survey, a roofline, a floor derived from the carry-less unit before tuning that rules out 28 billion iterations/s on one card, and every candidate we built and rejected, with its ratio (Section 5).
- The same optimisation ladder applied to Pollard rho on NIST P-256 and P-384 on the same RTX PRO 6000: 1.52× and 2.61× over the first working build, to 1.632 and 0.548 billion iterations/s, with an account of which levers carried over and how their sizes changed (Section 7).
- An inventory of the other GPU arithmetic in the repositories, prime-field (secp256k1 rho with order-six folding, baby-step giant-step, kangaroo) and binary-field (the ECC2K-95 kernel, pair tables, polynomial-system solvers), with their instruction ledgers, emulated walk constants and an honest statement of which have run on a device (Section 8).
- A pipelined-Karatsuba FPGA engine measured at 8.25 billion iterations/s on one AWS F2, inside a pre-board estimate of 5–12 (Section 9).

- The campaign itself: its configuration, the calibration of the distinguished-point interval (including the retraction of a wrong one), the storage and replay protocol, fleet economics, and its state at 486 M points and $2^{56.68}$ iterations (Section 10).
- Structural alternatives priced in the same unit, none of which come close: index calculus on the Koblitz curve at 10^7 times the cost of rho, and point decomposition 35–51 bits short of its budget (Section 11).

How we report numbers. One rule from the repository governs every section, so we state it once here. A change is measured as a ratio to a boundary that was written down before the change was attempted. That boundary is either a *floor*, a counting, generic-group or hardware argument the method cannot cross, or a *reference*, the best existing method on the same instance in the same unit. Every cost the method incurs goes inside the ratio: precomputation, verification, the inversion a batch shares, and the work still in flight when a collision lands. A number that prices only one phase is a stage diagnostic, never a speed. We then classify each change by what moved. An *advance* lowers the ratio to the floor. *Engineering* lowers the cost while the ratio to the floor stays flat. *Relabelling* lowers a headline while the total cost rises. *Accounting* changes a number without changing the algorithm. Every row in this paper falls into one of the last three. The same rule, applied across Pollard rho, baby-step giant-step, kangaroo and prime-field index calculus, is the subject of a companion draft in the sibling library [1], though this paper does not depend on it. The mistake we tried hardest to avoid is quoting a rate without its paired control, its hardware and its launch geometry, and Sections 5.3 and 10.2 each record a case where an earlier draft in the repository made exactly that mistake.

Availability. Every number in the paper has a footnote naming the file it came from. The campaign lives in a public repository, `crypto` (`https://github.com/aburan28/crypto`), and its files are cited by path from the repository root. A public sibling library, `cryptanalysis` (`https://github.com/aburan28/cryptanalysis`), holds an independent C golden model of the same field, a digit-serial FPGA core without vendor timing, an import of the 20 billion iterations/s GPU client with its own host re-walk, and the boundary ledger for index calculus; its paths carry the prefix `cryptanalysis:`. Two evidence records cited in Section 11 are in a third public repository, the research ledger (`https://github.com/aburan28/crypto-autoresearcher`), with the prefix `autoresearcher:`. Live campaign aggregates are published at `https://aburan28.github.io/crypto/status/`, and the snapshot this paper reports is committed next to the paper source.

What we do not claim. We have not recovered a logarithm on the challenge curve, and we do not expect one from the corpus collected so far; collection is currently paused. We quote no rate for hardware we did not measure. The L40S collection rate, the RTX PRO 4500 collection rate under the bridge map and the G7e instance family are unmeasured, and we say so where they come up. Projections, such as the 7.2–7.4 billion iterations/s fused build on the 4500, the table walk's 0.81–0.86 relative cost per solve, and the 136- and 144-engine F2 images, are labelled as projections wherever they appear. The NIST rates in Section 7 are throughput on a walk that will not finish, and say nothing about the security of those curves.

2 The curve, the field and the golden model

ECC2K-130 is the Certicom challenge [11]

$$E:\ y^2 + xy = x^3 + 1 \qquad \text{over } \mathbb{F}_{2^{131}},$$

a Koblitz curve [23] defined over $\mathbb{F}_2$, whose group order is $4 \cdot \ell$ with

$$\ell = 680564733841876926932320129493409985129,$$

a 129-bit prime.[1] The challenge gives points P and Q of order ℓ and asks for k with $Q = [k]P$. It has been open since 1997. The 2009 consortium estimated the work at $2^{60.9}$ iterations of a Frobenius-equivariant walk [3], and Section 3.4 measures our walk at $2^{60.91}$–$2^{60.92}$.

We did not take the curve on trust. $E(\mathbb{F}_2)$ has four points, so the Frobenius trace is $t = -1$, and the Koblitz recursion $s_m = t\,s_{m-1} - 2s_{m-2}$ gives $\#E(\mathbb{F}_{2^{131}}) = 2^{131} + 1 - s_{131} = 4\ell$. The sibling library's test suite checks the two facts that pin down *this* curve, on random points multiplied by the cofactor: $\sigma^2 + \sigma + 2 = 0$, where $\sigma(x, y) = (x^2, y^2)$ is the Frobenius, and $\ell \cdot R = \mathcal{O}$.[2][3] Converting the published challenge point out of the normal basis gives back Certicom's polynomial-basis hex, `05 1C99BFA6 F18DE467 C80C23B9 8C7994AA`.[4]

2.1 A type-II optimal normal basis

Because $2 \cdot 131 + 1 = 263$ is prime and 2 has order 131 modulo 263, $\mathbb{F}_{2^{131}}$ has a type-II optimal normal basis. Taking ζ to be a primitive 263rd root of unity, the basis is $\gamma_i = \zeta^i + \zeta^{-i}$ for $i = 1, \ldots, 131$, and an element is a 131-bit vector. Every design in this paper, on every platform, leans on three consequences of that choice.[5]

fact	consequence
$\gamma_i\gamma_j = \gamma_{i+j} + \gamma_{i-j}$ (indices folded by $\gamma_{263-k} = \gamma_k$, $\gamma_0 = 0$)	a product is a cyclic convolution of two symmetric 263-bit vectors or, after a Bernstein–Lange change of basis, a polynomial product with no reduction step
$\gamma_i^2 = \gamma_{2i \bmod 263}$	squaring is the index permutation $i \mapsto \text{fold}(2i)$, which is free in unrolled code and just wiring on an FPGA, so every Frobenius power σ^k costs nothing
the Hamming weight of the vector is invariant under σ and under negation $-(x, y) = (x, x + y)$	the iteration's branch selector and the distinguished-point test are functions on $\langle\sigma, -1\rangle$-classes that read the vector the hardware already holds

2.2 The golden model

The code generator models the field as symmetric vectors over $\mathbb{Z}/263\mathbb{Z}$ modulo the all-ones vector, with multiplication as cyclic convolution. That model is complete and obviously correct, and every generated routine is checked against it on 64 random inputs before it is written out.[6][7] The bitsliced multiply, square, inverse, σ^7 and Hamming weight are also tested differentially against a reference implementation that shares no code with them. We check that the iteration function commutes with Frobenius and with negation, that the collision solver recovers a planted logarithm, and that the distinguished-point comparison is right for every weight and cutoff. In all, `make test` runs 52 such checks across GF(2^{23}), GF(2^{41}), GF(2^{83}) and GF(2^{131}).[8]

The same model is the oracle for every other platform. The VHDL engine's reference script imports it directly and uses it to prove the basis-change maps, the multiplier route, σ^j, the inversion chain and a full step before it emits test vectors (Section 9).[9] The sibling library's

[1] `ecc2k130/README.md, "The problems"`.
[2] `cryptanalysis:fpga/README.md`.
[3] `cryptanalysis:fpga/model/ecc2k130_test.c`.
[4] `ecc2k130/README.md, "Validation"`.
[5] `ecc2k130/README.md, "Field representation"`.
[6] `ecc2k130/codegen/field.py`.
[7] `ecc2k130/codegen/gen.py`.
[8] `ecc2k130/README.md, "Validation"`.
[9] `hdl/ecc2k130/ecc2k_ref.py`.

C model of the same field and curve (`cryptanalysis:fpga/model/ecc2k130.c`) was written separately and re-walks every GPU report that library imports. When the two models agree on a record, they agree on the exact 131-bit vector in the same permuted basis, not merely up to a change of basis [1].

Longer runs exercise the reporting path rather than the algebra. On GF(2^{83}), 12.6 M iterations produced 172 distinguished points, within 30% of the predicted rate, and the reference recomputed 60 of them from their seeds without a mismatch, including walks that had been restarted. On the challenge curve itself, with the cutoff loosened from 34 to 50 so that points actually appear, 3.1 M iterations produced 12,368 reports, and the 25 we recomputed all matched exactly.[10]

2.3 ECC2K-95 as the end-to-end control

ECC2K-95 is the retired Certicom challenge on the same curve equation over $\mathbb{F}_{2^{97}} = \mathbb{F}_2[t]/(t^{97} + t^6 + 1)$, with group order 4ℓ for the 95-bit prime $\ell = 39614081257132074233778707191$. Harley and collaborators solved it in 1998 [19]. Since $2 \cdot 97 + 1 = 195$ is composite there is no type-II optimal normal basis, so the client runs a polynomial-basis backend and computes the orbit-invariant weight through one generated linear map into a normal basis, which is how Harley's own client did it.[11]

We recovered the parameters from Harley's surviving client source. The generator refuses to emit the curve unless both points lie on it, both have order ℓ, and the published answer

$$k = 378373084722315402694439814 58$$

satisfies $[k]P = Q$. The expected work is about 2^{44} iterations. Harley's group measured $2.16 \cdot 10^{13}$, against the $1.79 \cdot 10^{13}$ that this walk predicts from $\sqrt{\pi\ell/(4m)}$.[12] Per iteration the polynomial-basis field is about 1.9× cheaper than GF(2^{131}) in the normal basis (roughly 32,000 against 60,000 bitsliced instructions). That makes ECC2K-95 a job of a few GPU-hours where ECC2K-130 takes GPU-centuries, which is exactly what an end-to-end test of the whole pipeline needs: the same machinery at a scale that finishes.[13] The repository's separate ECC2K-95 CUDA kernel has so far run only under CPU emulation, where it recovers 21-bit and 40-bit toy logarithms at 0.94× and 1.32× its own prediction; we do not use it for any throughput claim.[14]

3 The walk

Pollard's rho [26], in the parallel collision-search form of van Oorschot and Wiener [29], runs many pseudo-random trails through the group, reports the distinguished points they pass, and solves the logarithm when two trails meet. On a Koblitz curve the Frobenius σ and negation generate a group of $2m = 262$ automorphisms acting on $\langle P \rangle$. A walk defined on the orbits of that group needs $\sqrt{262} \approx 16.2$ times fewer steps [13, 17, 30]. With $N = (\ell - 1)/262$ classes, the expected number of classes visited before a collision is $\sqrt{\pi N/2}$, which here is $2^{60.809}$.[15] Every walk in this paper is a map on those classes. They differ in how they respect the class action and in what each step costs.

[10] `ecc2k130/README.md, "Validation".`
[11] `ecc2k130/README.md, "ECC2K-130 and ECC2K-95".`
[12] `ecc2k130/README.md, "The problems".`
[13] `ecc2k130/README.md, "ECC2K-95".`
[14] `gpu/ecc2k/README.md.`
[15] `ecc2k130/WALK-CONSTANT.md, Âğ1.`

3.1 The σ-walk

The campaign uses the map of Bailey et al. [3]:

$$\begin{aligned} j &= 3 + \big((\mathrm{HW}(x_R) \gg 1) \bmod 8\big) \in [3, 10], \\ R' &= \sigma^j(R) + R, \\ \text{distinguished} &\iff \mathrm{HW}(x_R) \le w, \end{aligned}$$

with $w = 34$ by default in the client and $w = 32$ in the live campaign. Because the weight is a class invariant, $f(\sigma R) = \sigma f(R)$ and $f(-R) = -f(R)$, so the map descends to classes without ever computing a canonical representative inside the loop. The division by two in the selector matters more than it looks: x-coordinates of subgroup points always have even weight, so a selector on the raw weight would only ever use four of the eight branches.[16]

One step is one affine addition, with the inversion shared across a batch (Section 4). In the normal basis σ^j is an index permutation and costs nothing. As a scalar, the step is $R \mapsto [1+s^j]R$, where s is the root of $s^2 + s + 2 = 0$ that σ realises on $\langle P \rangle$. Selecting σ^j needs no branch: it is three conditional squarings, each a single `LOP3` per word, and j itself is never materialised.[17]

The walk tracks no coefficients. A walk is identified by its seed, and a report is the pair (seed, canonical endpoint), 32 bytes in all. The start point is $R_0 = Q + \sum_i c_i\, \sigma^i(P)$, where c is a 128-bit string from a PRF of the seed. It is computed with the same arithmetic and merged into finished lanes under a mask. Tracking a linear combination inside the loop would cost a 129-bit modular multiplication per step, which this walk cannot afford. Instead, collision resolution re-walks both trails and counts how often each branch $1 + s^j$ was applied. That gives endpoint $= [\mu](\alpha_0 P + Q)$ with $\mu = \prod_j (1 + s^j)^{n_j}$; the solver matches the two endpoints up to Frobenius and negation and solves for k modulo ℓ.[18] The σ-walk has no fruitless cycles: no product $\prod_j (1 + s^j)^{n_j}$ equals $\pm s^a$, so a trail can never come back to its own class.[19]

The client can optionally carry the eight branch counters as it goes (`WITNESS=1`). Because μ is a commuting product, that is just eight counters and nothing is multiplied per step. The payoff is that a third party can check a report with one scalar multiplication $[\mu]R_0$, 196 point operations, instead of re-walking the $2^{25.27}$ steps that a weight-34 report represents, an asymmetry of about $2^{17.7}$. On the bitsliced CPU walk this costs 6.0%, the median of three paired rounds (40.026 to 37.762 million iterations/s, a 5.7% drop in rate, against 33.8% predicted; an earlier revision measured 4.2% on a pre-merge tree). On the packed GPU walk the rate fell 34.7%, from 14.003 to 9.150 billion iterations/s. That figure is stated in the note, but only the job script is frozen under `benchmarks/witness-cost/`. Either way it is far above the 2% the note had set as its threshold for abandoning a 16-bit counter layout that was never built, so the campaign builds pin `WITNESS=0` and the record stays at 32 bytes.[20][21] A later fused kernel narrows the packed cost (9.347867 to 11.800903 billion iterations/s in witness-carrying mode) but does not close it.[22]

[16] `gpu/ecc2k/README.md`.
[17] `ecc2k130/README.md, "Iteration function"`.
[18] `ecc2k130/README.md, "Distinguished points and restarts"`.
[19] `ecc2k130/WALK-CONSTANT.md, Ãğ5`.
[20] `ecc2k130/CAIRN-WITNESS.md`.
[21] `ecc2k130/aws/build.sh`.
[22] `ecc2k130/benchmarks/sigma-fused/RESULTS.md`.

3.2 The r-adding table walk

On a GPU, the σ-walk pays for σ^j in the basis conversions around it (Section 4.2). An r-adding walk on the same classes avoids that cost:

$$\begin{aligned} h(R) &= (\mathrm{HW}(x)/2) \bmod 8, \\ k(R) &= \left(\textstyle\sum_e L(e)\, x_e\right) \cdot \mathrm{HW}(x)^{-1} \bmod 131, \\ \varepsilon(R) &= \text{bit } p(R) \text{ of } y, \\ R' &= R + (-1)^{\varepsilon}\, \sigma^k(T_h), \end{aligned}$$

where $T_h = [a_h]P + [b_h]Q$ and the 131×8-point table lives in shared memory (37.7 KB, or 48.5 KB per block with the selection tables). Since k shifts by one under σ and ε flips under negation, the walk descends to classes. Each step is one affine addition with a table operand whose Frobenius power is a lookup rather than a conversion.[23]

Unlike the σ-walk, an adding walk on classes does have fruitless cycles [6]. Two kinds show up here: four-step patterns in which the table points' Frobenius powers satisfy a relation coming from $\tau^2+\tau+2=0$, and six-step pairwise patterns. The first cycle rule let 24 four-step and 4 six-step patterns through. Observed against predicted counts were 1,145 against 1,312 (0.87 ± 0.03) for the τ-relation class and 126 against 166 for the pairwise class.[24] At the campaign's trail length of $2^{28.41}$ steps, a model built on those measured rates predicts that the cycles trap 53.7% of trails, a loss of 7.1–8.6× with the 2^{30} iteration guard.[25] A revised rule (v2) brings residual trapping down to $2.0 \cdot 10^{-5}$ of trails, at a 1.0048× iteration cost from merge parting. A third revision (v3, Section 3.5) replaces the history-dependent exits with a raw-cycle anchor.[26]

3.3 The x-only doubling-and-bridge map

On the power-capped RTX PRO 4500 a third map turns out to pay. Its common transition is $R' = R + \sigma(R)$, which is the scalar $[1+s]$. On this curve $x(R+\sigma R) = x + 1/x$, the square root of $x([2]R)$, so the walk can keep an x-only state. That scalar on its own generates a subgroup of index 12, so the map takes a sparse bridge $R' = R + \sigma^3(R)$ (index 109 on its own) whenever $\mathrm{HW}(x) \bmod 72 = 14$. Together the two transitions generate the full group, which the earlier [2]/[3] map had failed to do by an index of two (we called it "the scalar subgroup defect").[27] We froze a study of 2,000 trials on $\mathrm{GF}(2^{23})$, where the modulus-72 bridge predicate selects exactly what the earlier modulus-32 one did (weight 14 only). It gives mean charged work of 1.006696× that of the map selected at the time, so the new map's throughput gain (Section 5.5) is not given back in extra iterations. The map also passes an independent 2,048-point affine checkpoint.[28]

3.4 The walk constant, measured

Throughput is only half of what determines how long a solve takes. The other half is how many iterations the walk needs, which for a non-random map differs from the random-mapping $\sqrt{\pi N/2}$ by a constant c. We measure c as iterations divided by a random mapping's iterations on the class set, on small Koblitz curves of the same family. The device walk and a host emulation are measured separately, with an r-adding control using 256 branches alongside.[29]

[23] `ecc2k130/ITERATION-FUNCTION.md, Âğ4 and Âğ6.1.`
[24] `ecc2k130/WALK-CONSTANT.md, Âğ5.`
[25] `ecc2k130/WALK-CONSTANT.md, Âğ6.`
[26] `ecc2k130/WALK-CONSTANT.md, Âğ11.1.`
[27] `ecc2k130/README.md, "ECC2K-130 and ECC2K-95".`
[28] `ecc2k130/benchmarks/g7-12b-xonly-doubling-bridge/README.md.`
[29] `ecc2k130/WALK-CONSTANT.md, Âğ4.`

Table 1: Walk constant c on toy Koblitz curves, ECC2K-130 branch distribution ($H = 8$). Floor $c = 1$. The adding-walk control with 256 branches measures 1.0002 ± 0.0012 at $n = 23$. The injective-branch model $1/\sqrt{1 - \sum p^2}$ predicts 1.070 for the σ-walk at $n = 131$.

n	measured on	table walk	σ-walk
23	host emulation	1.0037 ± 0.0012	1.0995 ± 0.0013
23	device	1.0076 ± 0.0037	1.0948 ± 0.0040
31	host emulation	1.0035	1.0964
37	host emulation ($W = 16$)	1.0036	1.0949
41	host emulation	1.0125 ± 0.0059	1.0910 ± 0.0064
41	device	1.0051 ± 0.0299	1.0997 ± 0.0336
59	host emulation	0.9949	1.0817
pooled / extrapolated to $n = 131$		1.0035 ± 0.0006	[1.070, 1.082]

The σ-walk is one-to-one on each branch, so it pays the injective-branch penalty $1/\sqrt{1 - \sum_j p_j^2}$. With the weight distribution at $n = 131$ ($\sum p_j^2 = 0.127$) that penalty is 1.070. The measurements in Table 1 drift from 1.0995 at $n = 23$ toward it, and extrapolate to $[1.070, 1.082]$ at $n = 131$. The table walk is not injective per branch and sits at 1.0035 ± 0.0006 pooled, so the ratio c_t/c_σ is 0.928–0.938. The expected work for the campaign's σ-walk is therefore

$$2^{60.809} \times [1.070,\ 1.082] = 2^{60.91}\text{–}2^{60.92}$$

iterations. Under the original 2^{30} restart guard it would be a further 1.185× ($2^{61.15}$–$2^{61.17}$): a guard at three trail lengths cuts the longest 4.9% of trails and so throws away 15.6% of the steps (again a model on the measured rates). Bailey et al.'s $2^{60.9}$ holds up.[30] The guard has since been raised to 2^{32}, twelve trail lengths at weight 32, which discards only 0.007% of steps (1.00007×).[31]

As a direct check, on GF(2^{41}) with 128 walks, cutoff 13 and 64 planted logarithms, the σ-walk needed $164{,}200 \pm 9{,}900$ iterations per solve and the table walk $157{,}800 \pm 7{,}500$, a ratio of 0.96 ± 0.07. The bare prediction is 102,600; the difference is roughly 1.5× of harness overhead from the distinguished-point tail.[32]

3.5 Cost per solve, not rate

Put rate and constant together and the table walk looks very different. Its throughput advantage (Section 5.4) is 1.09–1.15× and its walk constant is 0.93×. But its as-built cycle rule is modelled to trap half of all campaign-length trails, so the as-built kernel's cost per solve was 4.85–6.26× that of the σ-walk. With rule v2 the projection improves to 0.81–0.86×, and the switch deadline, the fraction of the campaign after which switching no longer pays, is 15–22%. That projection is untested: the note declares the paired rate measurement for the v2 kernel that would test it, and it has not been run.[33] So the campaign still walks the σ-map, and the 20 billion iterations/s table-walk rows in Section 5.4 are rates, not costs per solve.

Rule v2 itself refused all 19,200 τ-cycles in a dedicated test, passed a 4,096-point host probe without a mismatch, solved 8/8 planted logarithms, and its scatter check against the predicted cycle counts gives $\chi^2 = 8.79$ on 15 degrees of freedom (the v1 rule gives 23.30).[34] Rule v3 then replaced the history-dependent exits with a raw-cycle probe of at most eight steps and a least-key anchor exit. It is checked by regression tests on a raw two-cycle found on the challenge

[30] `ecc2k130/WALK-CONSTANT.md, Âğ6.`
[31] `ecc2k130/benchmarks/max-iters/README.md.`
[32] `ecc2k130/ITERATION-FUNCTION.md, Âğ6.2.`
[33] `ecc2k130/WALK-CONSTANT.md, Âğ11.`
[34] `ecc2k130/WALK-CONSTANT.md, Âğ11.1 and Âğ11.6.1.`

curve and on synthetic entry-phase cycles, with 300 of 300 device reports re-walked and identical corpora across arms. V2's walk-constant and throughput figures do not carry over to it.[35] V3 needs a new table corpus; the campaign's σ-walk corpus is unaffected.

4 Field arithmetic: two representations, one model

Field multiplication dominates a step. The addition itself needs two products. With W walks sharing one inversion through Montgomery's trick [24], the product tree adds $3(W-1)/W$ more, plus $1/W$ of an Itoh–Tsujii inversion [21], which costs only eight multiplications in a basis where squaring is free (the client's addition chain is $1, 2, 4, 8, 16, 32, 64, 65, 130$; the FPGA's is $1, 2, 4, \ldots, 128, 130$).[36][37] Going from $W = 4$ to $W = 32$ is worth 60% on the CPU client, because it shrinks the amortised inversion from 25% to 3% of the multiplication budget.[38] How a multiplication is represented is therefore the central design decision, and the repository carries two answers.

4.1 Bitsliced: 32 walks in the bits of a word

The original client is bitsliced in Biham's sense [8]: one word operation advances W walks at once, one per bit lane, and a field operation is a straight-line program of word-wide Boolean instructions generated from the field model. The GPU uses 32-bit words. The host uses the widest it has (512 lanes with AVX-512, 256 with AVX2, 128 with NEON), and the arithmetic source is identical at every width.[39]

Multiplication follows Bernstein and Lange [5]. Both operands are converted from the normal basis to the optimal polynomial basis $\{1, c, c^2, \ldots\}$ with $c = \gamma_1$, multiplied as polynomials, and the 261-coefficient product is converted back. We generate both conversions from the substitution $c = z + 1/z$, which splits by parity as $H(c) = H_{\text{even}}(c^2) + c\,H_{\text{odd}}(c^2)$; because squaring is an index permutation, this yields an $O(K \log K)$ conversion. The generated `multPrep` is 331 instructions and the double-size inverse conversion 903, against 325 and 909 for the hand-designed chains in the literature.[40]

This backend taught us two things that change the usual accounting. The first is that three-input logic fusion (`LOP3` on NVIDIA, `vpternlogd` on AVX-512, `BSL/EOR3` on Arm with `FEAT_SHA3`) is worth 1.65×. A 131-bit multiplication is 14,554 two-input bit operations but only 8,859 instructions once $x \oplus y \oplus z$ and $x \oplus (y \wedge z)$ are single instructions. Since the fused form makes the XOR that accompanies an AND free, schoolbook leaves beat Karatsuba leaves [22]: full recursion costs 18,819 bit operations and 14,770 instructions, while stopping at a 17-bit schoolbook leaf costs more bit operations but fewer instructions. A search over balanced and unbalanced splits found nothing below 8,859. Toom-3 over $\mathbb{F}_2$, the source of Bernstein's 11,961-bit-operation chain [4], is not implemented.[41] The second lesson is that code size, not arithmetic, is the real wall. Inlining everything produced 285,096 PTX instructions for one kernel, and `ptxas` had still not finished register allocation after five minutes. Turning the multiplication, inversion, conversions, leaf, weight tree and σ^j into real subroutines brought it down to 36,553 lines and a 2.4 s assembly.[42]

The Hamming-weight tree is 268 instructions against 654 bit operations, because a full adder is two `LOP3`s. The whole bitsliced iteration comes to about 60,000 instructions per 32 walks

[35] `ecc2k130/CYCLE-ESCAPE-V3.md`.
[36] `ecc2k130/include/packed131.h`.
[37] `hdl/ecc2k130/README.md`.
[38] `ecc2k130/README.md`, "Throughput".
[39] `ecc2k130/README.md`, "Word width".
[40] `ecc2k130/README.md`, "Findings".
[41] `ecc2k130/README.md`, "What is not done".
[42] `ecc2k130/README.md`, "Findings".

on GF(2^{131}), as a static count. On the GPU that is the 0.85 billion iterations/s control of Section 5.3. For comparison, the instruction-count ceiling of the later packed kernel on the RTX PRO 6000 is 17.6 billion iterations/s (27.1 T lane-operations/s over about 1,540 lane-operations per update, a different count).[43]

4.2 Packed: one walk per thread, carry-less products

The packed backend holds one walk's coordinates in five 32-bit words per thread and multiplies with carry-less instructions.[44] Coordinates live in $\mathbb{F}_2[c]/(m)$ with $c = \gamma_1$, so a 131-bit product is a Karatsuba over carry-less multiplies (six `CLMAD`) followed by a reduction.[45] The normal basis, where the weight, branch selection and distinguished-point test live, is reached through the same Bernstein–Lange conversions, implemented as shift-and-mask networks and, for the Frobenius powers, as Beneš permutation networks.[46] Before CUDA 13.3 the carry-less product had to be built from integer multiplies. The native `clmad.lo/hi` instructions on Blackwell were worth +22.4% (Section 5.3), and they are why the campaign preset requires that compiler.[47]

The natural unit of account changes with the representation. In the packed kernel the shipping walk issues 4.81 products per update at batch 16 and about 2,324 static ALU slots.[48] The count that matters is `CLMAD`s, and Section 5.1 prices it. The reduction `reducePolynomial131` alone is 440.6 lane-instructions per update, 29% of the integer work of the 20 billion iterations/s build.[49]

4.3 Both at once, and bit-for-bit

The two backends, the CPU client at every word width, the VHDL engine and the sibling library's imported kernel all stay bit-for-bit compatible. A distinguished-point record written by any of them re-walks under any other, and every GPU report is re-walked on the host reference before we record a rate. The host check re-slices packed words into the same permuted type-II basis and compares vectors, not classes.[50] One corner case is worth mentioning. When $\sigma^j(R) = \pm R$, the addition's denominator is zero; this happens with probability about 2^{-131} per step. The σ-walk client and the VHDL engine do not special-case it. A zero denominator inverts to zero, the batch's points become garbage, and the next distinguished-point check or the iteration guard throws them away. The sibling C model and the table walk abort the step instead.[51][52]

5 The GPU client

On the GPU the exponent is fixed, so the only question is throughput. As everywhere in this paper, rates are in billions of iterations per second on one card. An iteration is one complete update of one walk, including its share of the batched inversion, the distinguished-point test and the restart path. Every row here is engineering: the walk and its collision structure stay the same, and the ratio to the generic-group floor does not move. What does move is the ratio to a second boundary, the GPU's carry-less unit, which we derived in Section 5.1 before tuning the kernel toward it.

[43] `ecc2k130/THROUGHPUT-CEILING.md`.
[44] `ecc2k130/PACKED.md`.
[45] `ecc2k130/ITERATION-FUNCTION.md, Âğ1`.
[46] `ecc2k130/FROBENIUS-NETWORK.md`.
[47] `ecc2k130/NATIVE-CARRYLESS.md`.
[48] `ecc2k130/ITERATION-FUNCTION.md, Âğ1 and Âğ3`.
[49] `ecc2k130/ROOFLINE.md`.
[50] `ecc2k130/README.md, "Validation"`.
[51] `ecc2k130/include/ref.h`.
[52] `hdl/ecc2k130/README.md`.

Table 2: Arithmetic floor of one affine-addition update on the RTX PRO 6000, and the budgets three throughput targets allow at 100% pipe utilisation. The carry-less unit issues 1.65 lane operations per SM-clock (1/37.7 of the logic pipe's 62.1, measured on an RTX PRO 4500 with the same SM and later confirmed on the 6000 at 1/38.0); sustained clock 2.30 GHz, maximum 2.43 GHz. Both floors sit above the 28 billion iterations/s budget.

component	`CLMAD`/upd.	ALU slots/upd.
4.81 products (6 `CLMAD` each)	28.9	≈ 830
squarings	5.0	≈ 80
batched inversion (/16)	4.6	≈ 270
floor	38.5 (28.9, squarings on ALU)	1,090–1,180
budget at 14.64 billion iterations/s	48.7–51.4	1,834–1,938
budget at 20 billion iterations/s	35.6–37.6	1,343–1,418
budget at 28 billion iterations/s	25.4–26.9	959–1,013

5.1 Two boundaries, written down first

Any walk that keeps the rho collision structure performs one affine addition per iteration. With Montgomery's batched inversion [24] across W walks, that addition costs a fixed number of field products plus $1/W$ of an inversion. In the packed representation a 131×131 product is a two-way Karatsuba over 64×64 carry-less multiplies, which is six `CLMAD` instructions. At batch $W = 16$ the shipping kernel issues 77 products per 16 slots, or 4.81 per update. Table 2 prices one update on the RTX PRO 6000 (188 SMs).[53]

The two pipes are independent, and each sets its own floor. On the carry-less unit, 28.9 `CLMAD` at 1.65 lanes per SM-clock is 17.5 SM-clocks per update, a ceiling of 24.7–26.1 billion iterations/s even if everything else were free. On the logic pipe, about 1,090 ALU slots already exceed the 959–1,013 that 28 billion iterations/s would allow. At 90% utilisation of either pipe the ceiling is 22.2–23.4 billion iterations/s. The note was written to answer one question: could a different iteration function take one card from the audited 14.64 to 28 billion iterations/s? The answer came before any kernel was built. It cannot, because 28 billion iterations/s is below the floor of any walk that performs one affine addition per iteration.

Our estimate of the carry-less rate went up as the kernels got closer to it. A kernel-mix measurement on the 6000 at 1.62 lane-`CLMAD`s per SM-clock priced the 20 billion iterations/s table-walk kernel at 33.1 `CLMAD` per update (28.9 products, 3.0 inversion, 1.25 normal-basis squarings) and gave a floor of 22.3 billion iterations/s.[54] A screened (not yet verified) three-limb Karatsuba arm then implied at least 1.654 lane-`CLMAD`s per SM-clock, which refuted that figure. The roofline of the 20.078 billion iterations/s build (Table 3) puts the carry-less speed of light at 27.4 billion iterations/s with the unit 2.00 lanes wide, while the logic pipe, at 1,319.6 lane-instructions per update, is 91.2% busy and runs out first.[55] Thirty billion iterations/s would need at most 30.3 `CLMAD` and 968 ALU slots per update, a 27% cut in integer work that the note calls "a two-card number". The 28 billion iterations/s verdict survives the revision because it never rested on the carry-less unit alone.

The same note measures the carry-less unit on other dies: 37.8 logic slots per `CLMAD.lo` on the 6000, 3.78 on the B200 and 2.00 on the H100. On the data-centre parts, then, the logic pipe binds by a wide margin, and on the B200 the carry-less floor alone would be 255 billion iterations/s.[56]

We had to correct the static accounting behind Table 2 once. An earlier SASS counter

[53] `ecc2k130/ITERATION-FUNCTION.md, Âğ1`.
[54] `ecc2k130/TWO-CHAINS.md, Âğ1`.
[55] `ecc2k130/ROOFLINE.md`.
[56] `ecc2k130/TWO-CHAINS.md, Âğ6.1-6.2`.

Table 3: Roofline of the 20.078 billion iterations/s table-walk build on the RTX PRO 6000: 188 SMs at 2.415 GHz, 22.61 SM-clocks per update. Work per update is measured lane-instructions; the ceiling is the rate at which that unit alone would saturate.

unit	peak lanes/SM-clk	work/update	ceiling (billion it/s)	busy
ALU (logic)	64	1,319.6	22.0	91.2%
`CLMAD`	2.00	33.1	27.4	73.2%
issue	128	1,698.9	34.2	58.7%
load/store	16	80.0	90.8	22.1%
FMA	64	188.6	154	13.0%

reported about 1,570 ALU slots and 29 `CLMAD` per update; its replacement counts 2,271 ALU and 45 `CLMAD` statically, or 2,324 once `POPC` and `FLO` are priced at their measured quarter rate.[57] The floor argument does not depend on which count is used, since the budgets are below both.

5.2 Acceptance rules

With two exceptions named in Section 5.7, every step in this section is a paired comparison on one GPU allocation: the candidate and control are interleaved, three to six repetitions each, and we report the candidate's ratio to the control for every pair. We adopt a change only if it clears a rule declared before the run. For most of the ledger that rule is a gain of at least 1% on both the benchmark and the DP34 collection workload, with every pair favouring the candidate. For the later table-walk work it is a geometric-mean ratio at or above a stated threshold, with every pair above a stated minimum.[58][59] Every adopted kernel re-walks every device report on the host reference (300 of 300 in the later notes) and recovers planted logarithms on GF(2^{41}). A candidate that fails the rule stays in the tree behind a flag, with its ratio on record; Section 5.7 collects them.

5.3 The packed-backend ledger: 0.85 to 14.64 billion iterations/s

The original client was bitsliced, with 32 walks in the bit lanes of a word and every field operation a straight-line program of `LOP3` instructions (Section 4.1). When we audited the packed replacement, that control measured 0.852294 billion iterations/s on an RTX PRO 6000.[60] Table 4 traces the path from there to the audited 14.637530 billion iterations/s (14.106673 billion iterations/s while collecting at weight 34). Each step is the corresponding note's own paired comparison. They do not form a single chain at constant occupancy and compiler, and where a note changed more than one thing at once, the table says so.

Sources, one per rung: packed basis [61]; single product [62]; denominator cache [63]; Frobenius networks [64]; polynomial chain [65]; paired products [66]; polynomial state [67]; direct reduction [68];

[57] `ecc2k130/ITERATION-FUNCTION.md, Âğ3.`
[58] `ecc2k130/NATIVE-CANDIDATES.md.`
[59] `ecc2k130/SIGMA-TABLE.md.`
[60] `ecc2k130/PACKED.md.`
[61] `ecc2k130/PACKED.md.`
[62] `ecc2k130/SINGLE-PRODUCT.md.`
[63] `ecc2k130/DENOMINATOR-CACHE.md.`
[64] `ecc2k130/FROBENIUS-NETWORK.md.`
[65] `ecc2k130/POLYNOMIAL-CHAIN.md.`
[66] `ecc2k130/PAIRED-PRODUCTS.md.`
[67] `ecc2k130/POLYNOMIAL-STATE.md.`
[68] `ecc2k130/DIRECT-REDUCTION.md.`

Table 4: Packed-backend rungs on one RTX PRO 6000. Each gain is the note's own paired comparison against the adjacent control, not a ratio of non-adjacent headlines. Blocks/SM is the resident-block bound; "conf." marks a comparison that also changed occupancy, compiler or walk population (the packed row's control ran 49 M walks once and its candidate 1.5 M walks three times). Class: engineering.

rung	control	candidate	gain
bitsliced control	—	0.852294	baseline
packed normal basis, five words (conf.)	0.852294	2.957961	3.47×
single polynomial product, 2 blocks/SM	2.956981	3.366572	+13.85%
denominator cache, 4 blocks/SM	3.506509	4.024103	+14.76%
same, 6 blocks/SM (conf.)	3.506509	4.094367	+16.76%
Frobenius permutation networks	4.115575	5.811421	+41.21%
polynomial-basis batch chain (conf.)	5.832342	6.054107	+3.80%
paired products (conf.)	6.123614	6.215430	+1.50%
polynomial-basis state	6.301859	6.547850	+3.90%
direct reduction	6.826154	6.906059	+1.17%
generated straight-line product (conf.)	6.860749	6.924275	+0.93%
256-worker tiles	6.852888	6.994745	+2.07%
native `clmad` (CUDA 13.3)	7.110440	8.703518	+22.40%
batch 16, 385,024 workers	8.673447	13.206088	+52.26%
weighted prefixes, paired Frobenius	13.110335	13.323276	+1.62%
compact 17-byte state	13.548376	14.403112	+6.31%
shared-memory mask table	14.296584	14.411102	+0.80%
public audit of that build	—	14.637530	DP34 14.106673

generated product [69]; tiles [70]; native carry-less [71]; batch tuning [72]; weighted prefixes [73]; compact state [74]; shared masks [75].

Three steps account for most of the factor, and each is a change of representation rather than a tuning knob. The Frobenius permutation networks (+41%) replace the per-step basis conversions around σ^j with Beneš networks over the permuted normal basis, checked on 3,120 GPU vectors and on 256 basis vectors under all 131 powers. Native carry-less multiplication (+22%) replaces an emulated 32×32 carry-less product with the `clmad.lo/hi` instructions that CUDA 13.3 exposes on Blackwell. That change in turn let the batch drop from 32 to 16 walks per inversion with 385,024 workers resident (+52%), at the same two-block occupancy and the same 122 registers per thread. The note suggests a cache-capacity explanation (the hot state shrinks from 245 to 122 MiB) but did not measure it.[76] Between the Frobenius-network confirmation (5.81 billion iterations/s) and the shipping walk (14.64 billion iterations/s), the gain is those two changes plus layout work. The table gives each its own pair, and we do not quote any single "remaining factor" as if it had been measured.

The σ-walk did not stop at 14.64. A fused single-pass variant measured 15.436677 against 15.015004 billion iterations/s (1.028×, five pairs). A σ step through nibble tables in shared memory (68,352 bytes, 512×1 blocks) measured 15.884369 against 15.513653 billion iterations/s, a paired median of 1.023930 with every pair at or above 1.0238 and an A/A drift of 0.099%.

[69] `ecc2k130/GENERATED-PRODUCT.md`.
[70] `ecc2k130/TILED-STATE.md`.
[71] `ecc2k130/NATIVE-CARRYLESS.md`.
[72] `ecc2k130/BATCH-TUNING.md`.
[73] `ecc2k130/WEIGHTED-PREFIX.md`.
[74] `ecc2k130/COMPACT-STATE.md`.
[75] `ecc2k130/SHARED-SIGMA.md`.
[76] `ecc2k130/BATCH-TUNING.md`.

That clears a pre-registered gate of geometric mean ≥ 1.015 with every pair ≥ 1.005.[77][78] These are the current σ-walk headlines. The campaign configuration of Section 10 was frozen before they existed and still ships the audited 14.64 build.

5.4 Beyond the shipping walk: the table walk and 20 billion iterations/s

The σ-walk spends part of every step on σ^j and the basis conversions around it. A redesigned r-adding table walk (Section 3.2) removes both. Each step adds a precomputed table point $\pm\sigma^k(T_h)$ whose Frobenius power is a shared-memory lookup, and the static ALU count drops from 2,324 to 1,831 slots per update. On the same host and automatic geometry it measured 16.560337 billion iterations/s against 14.412634 billion iterations/s for the shipping walk (+14.9%, six alternating repetitions, every paired ratio between 1.146 and 1.169). In the audited 385,024-worker geometry it measured 16.351936 against 14.975448 (+9.2%). All 300 device reports re-walked correctly, and all 64 planted logarithms were recovered on GF(2^{41}).[79][80]

Before the build, the note had set itself a target of 17.0 billion iterations/s (§4.4). Both medians missed it, by 2.6% and 3.8%, so under its own rule the table walk was not made the campaign default; it remains available behind `WALK_TABLE=1`. This is the acceptance rule doing its job, even when the result is a real speedup that falls short of the bar we set.

As first built, the table walk also changes the walk constant for the worse. Section 3.4 measures its cycle trapping at dpWeight 32 and prices the as-built kernel at 4.85–6.26 times the σ-walk's cost per solve; a revised cycle rule is projected, but not yet measured, at 0.81–0.86. The throughput rows here are therefore rates, not costs per solve.

With a different geometry the same walk goes further. A one-block layout (512 threads and one resident block per SM, which gives each block 64 KB of L1 instead of 28 KB), denominators rebuilt from the step tag instead of stored, inlined products and a pipelined selection pass took a 17.406 billion iterations/s reference to 20.078 billion iterations/s (+15.3%, five samples in 20.077–20.080). That is 0.73 of the 27.4 billion iterations/s carry-less speed of light (0.90 of the since-refuted 22.3). The geometry alone was worth +9.4%, tag denominators +1.5% and inlining +2.3%. Collecting at weight 34 it holds 19.04 billion iterations/s against 16.70. All 300 reports re-walked correctly, and the distinguished-point count matched the reference's 472,776.[81] This is the `gpu-rtx-pro6000-20b` build. A later cycle-escape revision of the table walk (rule v3, Section 3.5) rebuilt the kernel shape. Its own ladder, from 1.04 to 5.10 billion iterations/s, belongs to a different walk and cannot be compared with the 20 billion iterations/s rows.[82]

5.5 The second card: RTX PRO 4500

The campaign's second GPU family is the RTX PRO 4500 (82 SMs, 165 W) in the AWS `g7.2xlarge`. We keep its ledger separate because on this card the power cap binds, not the pipe. The shipping walk measures 5.107 billion iterations/s here at 1.95 GHz, within about 1% of what the 6000's per-SM-clock rate predicts (Section 10.3). The card's own best preset before the map change sat near 6.2 billion iterations/s. Candidates such as the larger split batches were slower here because they raised memory activity, and the power cap answered by lowering the clock.[83][84] We had declared a goal of 12 billion iterations/s for this card (Section 10.3), and it was reached by changing the map rather than the kernel. The complete two-bridge x-only map of Section 3.3 measured a median of 12.499203 billion iterations/s against 11.218437 billion

[77] `ecc2k130/benchmarks/sigma-fused/RESULTS.md`.
[78] `ecc2k130/SIGMA-TABLE.md`.
[79] `ecc2k130/ITERATION-FUNCTION.md, Âğ6.2-6.3`.
[80] `ecc2k130/benchmarks/table-walk/comparison.json`.
[81] `ecc2k130/ONE-BLOCK-GEOMETRY.md`.
[82] `ecc2k130/CYCLE-ESCAPE-V3.md`.
[83] `ecc2k130/ITERATION-FUNCTION.md, Âğ6.3`.
[84] `ecc2k130/README.md, "larger split-batch experiment"`.

Table 5: Modal GPU survey, automatic workers, packed recipe. Unit: billion complete iterations/s. The last column is trillions of iterations per dollar at Modal list price. Class: engineering.

GPU	billion it/s	/ 6000	it/$ (T)
RTX PRO 6000, 385k workers	15.116	1.000	17.95
RTX PRO 6000, automatic	14.470	0.957	17.19
B200	8.840	0.585	5.09
L40S	8.696	0.575	16.04
H200	7.632	0.505	6.05
B300	7.575	0.501	3.84
H100	7.540	0.499	6.87
A100-80GB	4.632	0.306	6.67
A100-40GB	4.618	0.305	7.92
L4	2.561	0.169	11.54
A10	2.423	0.160	7.92
T4 (no `clmad`)	0.541	0.036	3.30

iterations/s for its matched modulus-32 control, a paired geometric-mean ratio of 1.121079 with 95% interval [1.105668, 1.136704]. A fresh three-run confirmation gave 12.567029, 12.457221 and 12.366415 billion iterations/s, and the production build ran at 12.632704 billion iterations/s over 2^{36} updates.[85][86] We have not measured its DP34 collection rate on this card, so we do not give one.

5.6 Per-GPU survey

The campaign default is the RTX PRO 6000, but Modal also rents T4, L4, A10, L40S, A100, H100, H200, B200 and B300. Table 5 runs one packed walk with automatic workers and three valid `-bench` repeats on twelve catalogue SKUs. Nothing beat the 6000. This walk is bound by integer and carry-less throughput, not by tensor cores, so the usual rankings of GPUs for machine-learning work do not carry over: on this kernel the B200 is 0.585× the 6000 and the H100 is half. [87]

On the B200, an automatic sweep over twenty single-knob arms (launch geometry, product form, scheduling, memory residency) later lifted the table-walk build from 15.365 to 19.402 billion iterations/s (1.2627, every pair in 1.2623–1.2632). The winning combination of the fused pass, batch 32, three-limb Karatsuba and 512-thread blocks was adopted as `gpu-b200-19b`. The same sweep on the 6000 found a 640×1 arm at 19.993 against 19.951, with two of five pairs below one, and adopted nothing.[88] The trades that change sign from one die to the other are exactly those that move work from the logic pipe onto the carry-less unit. The top-bit correction on `CLMAD` costs 15% on the 6000 but gains 13.4% on the B200, and stacked there with the normal-basis inversion and λ^2 on `CLMAD` it reaches 1.379× (15.372 billion iterations/s), just as the per-die `CLMAD` rates of Section 5.1 predict. A two-chain kernel that splits each warp's Montgomery chain in two lost on both dies (0.826× on the B200, 0.696× on the 6000), which points to the register file rather than to any unit's rate.[89]

[85] `ecc2k130/README.md, "ECC2K-130 and ECC2K-95".`
[86] `ecc2k130/benchmarks/g7-12b-xonly-doubling-bridge/README.md.`
[87] `ecc2k130/benchmarks/modal-gpus/SURVEY.md.`
[88] `ecc2k130/AUTOSWEEP.md.`
[89] `ecc2k130/TWO-CHAINS.md, Âğ5, Âğ6.2 and Âğ6.4.`

Table 6: GPU candidates measured and declined. Ratio is candidate over the paired control; intervals are 95% paired bootstrap where the note reports one. "4500" rows are on the RTX PRO 4500 against the selected runtime of the day; the others are on the RTX PRO 6000.

candidate	control	candidate	ratio
stream Karatsuba compile option	0.857	0.748	0.873
integer add in place of OR in `clmul32`	6.8615	6.8080	0.992
top three-bit correction moved onto `CLMAD`	15.116	12.859	0.851
batch 12 / 10 against batch 16	14.26	13.75 / 13.70	$<$ screen
batch 18 against batch 16 (larger population)	14.47	14.29	$<$ screen
table walk against pre-declared 17.0 billion iterations/s	14.41	16.56	1.149, missed
two Montgomery chains per warp	19.981	13.903	0.696
λ-projective coordinates (priced, not built)	—	ceiling 11.8–12.5	< 14.41
4500: hybrid reduction	6.2459	5.3459	0.852 $[0.845, 0.860]$
4500: half-native product tail	6.1898	6.0303	0.977 $[0.971, 0.982]$
4500: quotient fan-in	6.1739	6.0139	0.977 $[0.972, 0.982]$
4500: register-retained inverse, 3 / 4 blocks	6.1724	6.1487 / 5.6922	0.997 / 0.924
4500: paired inverse leaves, 3 / 4 blocks	6.1643	6.1146 / 5.6501	0.994 / 0.918
4500: logical-pair inversion, 3 / 4 blocks	6.1675	6.1037 / 5.6723	0.960 / 0.921
4500: seven-node inversion, 3 / 4 blocks	6.1826	6.1388 / 5.6904	0.995 / 0.923
4500: seven-node shared-X cache, six slots	6.2624	6.3741	1.010 $[0.991, 1.029]$
4500: split batch 24 / 32	6.2742	6.1218 / 5.9950	0.972 / 0.948
4500: direct polynomial δ-3/4 routing	6.2724	4.3635	0.690 $[0.676, 0.704]$
4500: 65/66-bit, 33-bit products; byte masks (four)	—	—	all < 1

5.7 What was declined

Table 6 lists every GPU candidate that we built, measured against the rule, and did not adopt. We record them so that anyone who has the same idea later finds a measurement rather than folklore. Every row passed its correctness checks; what fell short was the rate.

Sources: stream Karatsuba [90]; add-combine [91]; top-`CLMAD` [92]; batch screen [93]; two chains [94]; λ-projective [95]; the 4500 rows [96], each linking its `benchmarks/g7-*` directory.

Two rows need a word of explanation. The λ-projective candidate was never built. Priced in the unit of Table 2, it came to 60.5 `CLMAD` per update against 38.1 for affine at batch 16, a ceiling of 11.8–12.5 billion iterations/s, below the 14.41 we had already measured. The condition we had declared for building it (a negative cost difference at $W = 16$) could not be met, so we did not start. The top-`CLMAD` and stream-Karatsuba rows are the two comparisons in this section that were not interleaved on one allocation (the stream-Karatsuba pair also differs in source digest). We report both with that caveat; neither would have cleared the rule in any case.

6 CPU clients

The CPU client is the bitsliced backend at the host's word width. It matters for three reasons. It is how every GPU report gets verified, it runs the ECC2K-95 end-to-end control, and the campaign's spot fleet included CPU workers whose points cannot be told apart from the GPUs'.

[90] `ecc2k130/TUNING.md`.
[91] `ecc2k130/ADD-COMBINE.md`.
[92] `ecc2k130/TOP-CLMAD.md`.
[93] `ecc2k130/COMPACT-STATE.md`.
[94] `ecc2k130/TWO-CHAINS.md`.
[95] `ecc2k130/LAMBDA-PROJECTIVE.md`.
[96] `ecc2k130/README.md, "ECC2K-130 and ECC2K-95"`.

Table 7: Bitsliced CPU client, GF(2^{131}), one core, median of five. Speedups are against the g++ 64-lane build on the same host. The 2009 qhasm implementation of Bailey et al. reached 533 cycles per iteration on a Core 2 with 128-bit vectors.

host	word	lanes	million it/s	note
Xeon 2.1 GHz	`uint64_t`	64	4.42	475 cycles/iteration
Xeon 2.1 GHz	AVX2	256	10.7	196 cycles/iteration
Xeon 2.1 GHz	AVX-512	512	12.6	167 cycles/it.; 4 threads 40 M
M4 Pro, g++ 16.1	NEON	128	11.342	2.19× over 64 lanes (5.185)
M4 Pro, Apple clang 17	NEON	128	15.673	3.02× over g++/64
Graviton3 (V1, SHA3), clang	NEON	128	6.214	2.38× over g++/64
Graviton2 (N1, no SHA3), clang	NEON	128	4.220	2.09× over g++/64
Modal container, 4 threads	AVX-512	512	12.4	49.4 million iterations/s on 4 threads

Table 7 collects the measurements.[97] Two observations from it apply more widely. First, the AVX-512 build spends half of each multiply moving data rather than computing (4,069 logic instructions against 4,287 `vmovdqa32`), because the Karatsuba leaf keeps 254 values live with only 32 registers. A scheduling pass over the same DAG recovered moves only in the conversion (4,287 to 3,903), missed its declared target, and left the leaf size and the compiler on record as measured dead ends.[98] Second, on aarch64 the gain splits cleanly. On the M4 Pro the NEON word with `BSL` alone is worth 1.76× and `EOR3` a further 1.24×, and a core without `FEAT_SHA3` (Graviton2) still gets 1.81× from the wider word and `BSL`. On this code the compiler matters more than either: gcc emits 9,372 instructions for the multiply leaf, 59% of them loads and stores of spilled temporaries, where clang emits 1,902 plus five outlined calls. We only enable the SHA3 path when the CPU reports the feature. An ungated probe on a Graviton2 picks a `+sha3` spelling under both compilers, and the resulting binary dies with `SIGILL` on its 8,907 `eor3` instructions.[99]

In the fleet, a CPU worker at 2.3 billion iterations/s (the self-reported median of the twelve CPU slots on 2026-09-17) was worth about a sixth of an RTX PRO 6000. On Modal, a 32-thread (16-core) sidecar running beside a GPU adds about 25% to the container's cost for 2.7% more iterations, so it is off by default.[100][101]

7 The same ladder on the NIST curves

Most of what made the ECC2K-130 client fast has nothing to do with binary fields. Sharing one inversion across many walks, using the hardware's own carry instructions instead of emulating them, choosing the launch shape by measurement, and refusing occupancy trades that look good on paper are all properties of an affine-addition rho walk on a GPU, not of $\mathbb{F}_{2^{131}}$. So once the ECC2K-130 ladder was written down, the obvious question was how much of it carries over to a prime-field walk. We tried it on NIST P-256 and P-384, on the same RTX PRO 6000, and this section reports what happened.

Two things should be clear before the numbers. First, these are throughput measurements on a walk that nobody expects to finish: at the rates below a P-256 collision is still about 10^{30} seconds away, and nothing here says anything about the security of the NIST curves. Second, every row is engineering in the sense of Section 1. The walk computes the same function on the same curve at every rung, with one step per counted step, so $S = \text{steps}/\sqrt{n}$ does not move;

[97] `ecc2k130/README.md, "Throughput"`.
[98] `ecc2k130/HOST-SCHEDULE.md`.
[99] `ecc2k130/README.md, "Word width"`.
[100] `ecc2k130/benchmarks/dp-interval/raw/worker-counters-2026-09-17.tsv`.
[101] `ecc2k130/README.md, "Walking on the container's CPUs too"`.

only the cost of a step does.[102]

7.1 The walk and the field

The library holds a P-256 element in eight 32-bit limbs and a P-384 element in twelve, one element per thread, with CIOS Montgomery multiplication. Both primes have low limb $2^{32}-1$, so the Montgomery constant is $n' = 1$, and every limb of either modulus in radix 2^{32} is 0, 1, $2^{32}-1$ or $2^{32}-2$; the reduction row therefore needs carries but no multiplications. A generalised-Mersenne (Solinas) field is kept alongside as a matched competitor, so that the device rather than an argument decides between the two.[103] Both representations are checked on 20,000 random pairs per curve against Boost.Multiprecision, and the Jacobian doubling and mixed addition against independent affine arithmetic. The benchmark protocol was pre-registered before any device time: workloads, seeds, the threads-per-block and register-cap sweep, and a 5% threshold below which the simpler configuration wins by rule.[104]

The rho walk on top of the field mirrors the structure of Section 3, minus the Frobenius. It is an r-adding walk on the low bits of x with the negation map as the only fold (fold 2, a $\sqrt{2}$ saving; $j \neq 0$ on both curves, so ± 1 is the whole automorphism group), distinguished points by a mask on the next byte at probability 2^{-24}, fruitless two-cycles detected and escaped, and walks batched per thread so that one inversion serves all of them through Montgomery's trick.[105] The inversion is Fermat's a^{p-2} with a four-bit fixed window, which for P-256 is on the order of 256 squarings and 64 window multiplications (our count from the exponent length, not a measured figure). That is the important difference from the binary field. On ECC2K-130 an inversion costs eight multiplications because squaring is free (Section 4); here it costs a few hundred, so the batch width W matters far more.

The host test suite runs the exact kernel body on the CPU: group-law identities, determinism of a single step, the negation fold as a class function, and an end-to-end logarithm on a toy curve of order about 2^{20}, where the folded walk needs the expected $\sqrt{2}$ fewer steps than the unfolded one.[106]

The CPU solver across all fifteen curves. The GPU walk has a CPU counterpart: a host solver that takes any of the fifteen FIPS 186-4 curves (P-192 to P-521, K-163 to K-571, B-163 to B-571), audits it for the structural precondition of each known attack (trace one, composite order, embedding degree at most 100, composite extension degree), and runs the branch the curve calls for: Smart–Semaev–Satoh–Araki, Pohlig–Hellman, interval baby-step giant-step and kangaroo, or whole-group rho. The audit certifies the absence of every precondition on all fifteen. The rho folds the negation map everywhere and the Frobenius on the Koblitz curves, the class of size $2m$ carried exactly through the eigenvalue λ of τ on the subgroup, which is the binary-curve cousin of the σ-class walk of Section 3. On one host we measured interval solves of width 2^{20} to 2^{32} on P-256, K-283 and B-409 in 43 ms to 8.7 s with the planted scalar recovered every time; Frobenius folding on toy Koblitz curves cutting additions by the predicted $\sqrt{2m}$ (6.8× at $m = 23$, 9× at $m = 41$) at a cost of m squarings per step; and the Smart attack breaking CM-constructed anomalous curves of 129, 257 and 522 bits in 3, 10 and 33 ms. No full-width scalar has been recovered on any NIST curve, and none of the fifteen has a structural weakness; the documentation says both.[107]

[102] `gpu/nist/RESULTS.md`.
[103] `gpu/nist/README.md`.
[104] `research/nist_gpu_arithmetic_20260926/PROTOCOL.md`.
[105] `gpu/nist/nist_rho.cuh`.
[106] `gpu/nist/README.md`, "Correctness".
[107] `docs/ECDLP_NIST.md`.

Table 8: ECC2K-130 levers applied to the NIST P-256 and P-384 rho walk on one RTX PRO 6000. Rates are in billions of iterations per second. Each NIST ratio compares adjacent cells of the same sweep; the cells are single runs, not the interleaved repeated pairs of Section 5. Rows marked * come from the round-2 sweep, which at the time of writing is in an open pull request. Class: engineering.

NIST rung	ECC2K-130 analogue	cells compared	P-256	P-384
first working build	bitsliced control	portable, 128 thr., $W = 8$	1.075	0.210
explicit PTX carry chains	native `clmad` (+22.4%)	same cell, PTX build	1.19×	1.38×
compile-time W, $W = 8 \to 16$	batch tuning (+52%)	256 thr., PTX	1.08×	1.37×
128 → 256 threads/block	launch geometry (+9.4%)	$W = 16$, PTX	1.03×	1.01×
$W = 32$, register-resident inversion*	batch tuning	256 thr., $W = 16 \to 32$	1.22×	1.31×
register caps 96/128/160*	two chains, blocks/SM (declined)	256 thr., $W = 32$	0.97×	0.82–0.83×
best cell*		PTX, 256 thr., $W = 32$	**1.632**	**0.548**
cumulative*		from the first working build	**1.52**×	**2.61**×

7.2 Getting a first honest number

The kernel had been written and verified entirely on hosts without a GPU (Section 8.1), and the first device run measured nothing at all. The batched-inversion routine was marked host-only, and `nvcc`, after a warning, silently dropped the call from device code. The walk kernel compiled to a load and an exit: four registers, no stack, microseconds per launch and zero distinguished points. The CPU tests could not have caught it, because the host compiler happily compiles host-only code. A second bug, an unguarded `atomicAdd` on a null cycle counter, faulted on the first fruitless two-cycle, which arrives about once every 512 steps. Both are fixed and now covered by tests, and the device benchmark checks every launch for errors.[108]

This is the same lesson that Section 4.1 drew from code size, in a different form: a static count or a host emulation tells you what the device ought to do, and only the device tells you what it did. Our correctness check on hardware is therefore the distinguished-point count. Because the walk is deterministic and points are distinguished with probability 2^{-24}, every cell must report about walks × iterations/2^{24} of them. Every cell did, for example 11,969 observed against 12,085 expected on the first P-256 run and 12,154 against 12,096 in the best cell.[109] The CPU suite also checks the specialised steppers below bit for bit against the generic one, for every batch width that was compiled.

7.3 The rungs

Table 8 lines the NIST rungs up against the ECC2K-130 rungs they borrow from. The starting point is the portable build at 128 threads per block and $W = 8$: 1.075 billion iterations/s on P-256 and 0.210 on P-384, both on one RTX PRO 6000 Blackwell (188 SMs, CUDA 13.3, `sm_120`).

[108] `gpu/nist/RESULTS.md, "What this round fixed"`.
[109] `gpu/nist/RESULTS.md, "Correctness evidence on hardware"`.

Carry chains. On ECC2K-130 the single largest instruction-level gain was letting the hardware do the carry-less product itself. The prime-field counterpart is the carry: a portable C++ multi-precision product hides its carries in compares and adds, and Section 8.2 already showed that the 256-bit product is carry-bound rather than multiply-bound. Writing the product rows and the sparse reduction with explicit `mad.lo.cc`/`madc.hi.cc` chains lifted the walk by 1.19× on P-256 and 1.38× on P-384 at the same launch shape (1.282 and 0.289 billion iterations/s). The larger gain on P-384 is what one would expect from twelve limbs instead of eight: there are more carries per product to save. At the field level the same change took a dependent Montgomery multiply from 54.9 to 73.4 billion multiplications/s on P-256 and from 20.3 to 32.2 billion multiplications/s on P-384. Under the pre-registered protocol the Solinas competitor did not win either. On P-256 the two multiplications are within 5% (70.4 against 73.4 billion multiplications/s), a tie that the protocol awards to the simpler configuration. On P-384 the Solinas multiplication is 14% faster (36.7 against 32.2) but the Montgomery doubling is 4% faster (1,712 against 1,647 million doublings/s). These field rows are a first run at one block size, not the protocol's three repeats, so the question stays open.[110] The walk is built on the Montgomery field for both curves; a Solinas walk has not been compiled or measured.[111]

Batch width. This is where the two fields differ most, and the reason is the inversion. On ECC2K-130 the batch went *down*, from 32 walks per inversion to 16, because an inversion was already cheap and a smaller hot state fitted the cache better. On the NIST curves an inversion costs hundreds of multiplications, so every extra walk sharing it pays. Templating the stepper on W at compile time let the per-walk arrays live in registers instead of 64-wide local arrays, and the rate climbed with W on every geometry: at 256 threads per block from 0.466 at $W = 2$ to 1.340 at $W = 16$ on P-256, and from 0.096 to 0.438 on P-384 (Figure 1).[112] A second round passed the inversion's scratch arrays by reference and compiled a $W = 32$ instance. That cell reached 1.632 and 0.548 billion iterations/s, 1.22× and 1.31× over $W = 16$ at the same geometry.[113] We cannot cleanly split that gain between the larger batch and the by-reference inversion, because round 1 never compiled $W = 32$. What we can say is that at $W \leq 16$ the two rounds agree within noise (1.306/0.434 against 1.310/0.408 at 128 threads, $W = 16$), which suggests, without proving it, that most of the gain comes from the batch.

Launch shape. Doubling threads per block from 128 to 256 was worth 2.6% on P-256 and under 1% on P-384 at $W = 16$. That is small next to the one-block geometry's 9.4% on ECC2K-130, and it makes sense: the binary kernel was shaped by a shared-memory table and an L1 budget, while the prime-field walk is limited by registers.

What was declined. At $W = 32$ both instantiations sit at the 255-register ceiling. The obvious counter-move is a register cap, trading spills for occupancy, and the round-2 sweep tried caps of 96, 128 and 160 registers. All of them lost to the unrestricted build: P-256 fell to 1.589–1.595 and P-384 to 0.447–0.455. That matches the ECC2K-130 experience with the two-chain kernel and the four-block configurations of Table 6: on this card, occupancy bought with spilled state has not paid on either field.

7.4 What carried over and what did not

Three of the ECC2K-130 levers transferred directly. Native carry handling, batch width and the refusal of register caps all moved the NIST walk in the same direction they moved the binary

[110] `gpu/nist/RESULTS.md, "Field arithmetic"`.
[111] `gpu/nist/nist_curve.cuh`.
[112] `gpu/nist/RESULTS.md, "Rho walk"`.
[113] `gpu/nist/RESULTS.md, round 2 (aburan28/crypto pull request 1778)`.

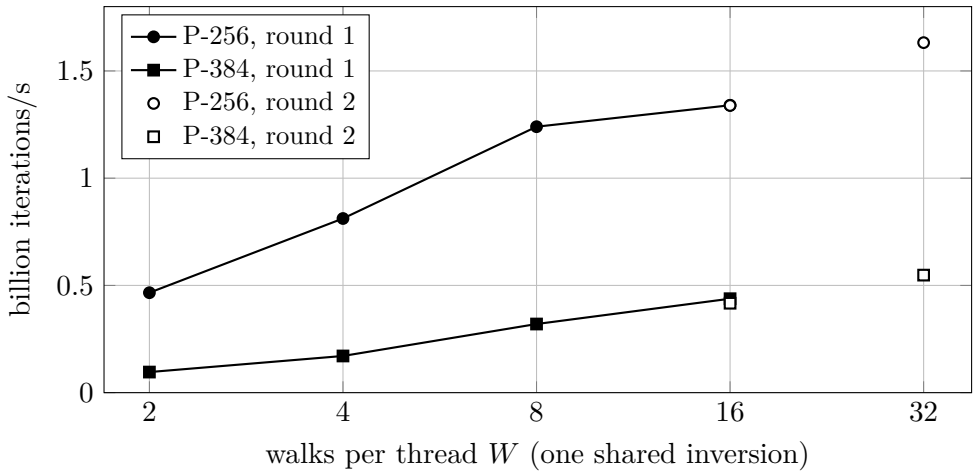


Figure 1: The NIST rho walk on one RTX PRO 6000 at 256 threads per block, PTX build, unrestricted registers, against the batch width W. Filled markers are the round-1 sweep, open markers the round-2 sweep with the by-reference inversion and the $W = 32$ instance. Each point is one cell of 8,192 iterations; distinguished-point counts matched the 2^{-24} rate in every cell.

one, and the combined effect was 1.52× on P-256 and 2.61× on P-384 over the first working build. The size of each lever did not transfer. The batch width, a modest knob on ECC2K-130, was the largest single factor here because a prime-field inversion takes some forty times as many multiplications as a normal-basis one. Launch geometry, a real gain on the binary walk, was nearly flat. In other words the ladder carried over, but its rungs were spaced differently, and the only way to find the spacing was to measure it.

The comparison also puts the two walks on one scale. On the same card the ECC2K-130 campaign build runs 14.64 billion complete iterations per second and the best P-256 walk 1.63 billion iterations, a factor of about nine. A 131-bit binary product is six `CLMAD` instructions; a 256-bit prime product is two hundred or so carry-chained integer instructions (Table 10). That factor of nine is the carry-less unit's advantage made concrete.

The obvious next rungs are the ones the round-2 record names: a $W = 64$ instance (which will spill at the register ceiling and probably lose, but is worth one cell to confirm), reseeding off the critical path, and a second walk per step from the same table read. A repeated, interleaved pairing of the best cell against its control, in the style of Section 5, would also turn these single-run ratios into intervals. None of that changes the exponent, and none of it is meant to.

8 The other GPU kernels: prime fields and binary fields beyond ECC2K-130

The ECC2K-130 client is one of several GPU arithmetic libraries in the two repositories. The others target the 256-bit prime field of secp256k1 (a Koblitz curve in the SEC sense, with $j = 0$ and the order-3 endomorphism), the NIST primes, the polynomial-basis field of ECC2K-95, and the linear algebra and polynomial-system solvers that index calculus needs. They follow the same discipline as the ECC2K-130 client: a Python or Rust oracle, a host emulation of the identical device source, bit-identical steppers, planted logarithms, and static instruction accounting from the assembler. What most of them still lack is a measurement on a device. We start by saying which is which, because a static instruction count and a measured rate are different kinds of evidence, and the rest of the paper keeps them apart.

Table 9: GPU arithmetic in the two repositories by evidence class. "Emulated" means the device source was executed on the host and checked against an oracle; "static" means instruction, register and stack counts from `ptxas` with no execution.

kernel family	field	on a device	otherwise
ECC2K-130 client (Sections 5, 10)	$\mathbb{F}_{2^{131}}$, ONB	measured, audited	emulated, static
F4 Gröbner elimination (sibling)	$\mathbb{F}_2$ Macaulay matrices	measured (RTX 5090, H100)	emulated
Macaulay reduced echelon	$\mathbb{F}_p$, $p = 2083$	one scheduling run (RTX PRO 4500)	emulated, static
secp256k1 / Curve25519 rho, baby-step giant-step	$\mathbb{F}_p$, two 256-bit primes	never	emulated, static
secp256k1 kangaroo	$\mathbb{F}_p$, 256-bit	never	emulated, static
P-256 / P-384 field and rho walk (Section 7)	$\mathbb{F}_p$, 256- and 384-bit	measured (RTX PRO 6000, 2026-10-12)	host-verified; protocol pre-registered
ECC2K-95 kernel	$\mathbb{F}_{2^{97}}$, polynomial basis	never	emulated, static
Semaev S_4 sweep; FES	$\mathbb{F}_{2^n}$; $\mathbb{F}_2$	never	host-timed; emulated
sparse matrix–vector	$\mathbb{Z}/m$, $m < 2^{63}$	never	CPU-rechecked
64-bit prime-field rho (sibling)	$\mathbb{F}_p$, $p < 2^{64}$	never	emulated, static

8.1 What has and has not run on a GPU

Table 9 is the inventory. Every "never" repeats a sentence in that family's own README, and the reason is the same each time: the code was written and verified in containers with no GPU or no complete CUDA toolkit, and the device runs were planned for rented hardware that the campaign's account hold (Section 10.5) or missing credentials then put out of reach. The NIST kernels were in the same position until they finally ran, which is the subject of Section 7.[114][115][116][117][118] The numbers below are therefore of three kinds, and we label each one: a static count, an emulated operation count or walk constant, or (in Section 8.7) a device measurement.

8.2 256-bit prime-field arithmetic for secp256k1

The field layer holds an element in eight 32-bit limbs, because the integer datapath is 32 bits wide and the carry-chain instructions `mad.lo.cc`, `madc.hi.cc` and `addc` exist only at that granularity. For secp256k1 the 512-bit product is folded with $2^{256} \equiv 2^{32} + 977 \pmod{p}$, about 40% fewer multiply-adds than Montgomery; for any other odd modulus below 2^{256} a Montgomery CIOS path is used, and the scalar ring modulo n reuses it on the host. Points are Jacobian with the standard $a = 0$ doubling ($2M + 5S$) and mixed addition ($7M + 4S$) formulas. The library is a throughput library, not a signing library, and is not constant-time.[119][120] A second special-reduction path, added in October 2026, serves Curve25519 (Ed25519's prime-order group in short-Weierstrass form, $p = 2^{255} - 19$, folded with $2^{256} \equiv 38$) through the same walk, baby-step giant-step and test suites; it is host-verified against the RFC 7748 constants and has not run on a device.[121]

[114] `gpu/ecc/README.md`.
[115] `gpu/btcpuzzle/README.md`.
[116] `gpu/ecc2k/README.md`.
[117] `research/nist_gpu_arithmetic_20260926/ATTEMPT.md`.
[118] `cryptanalysis:docs/GPU.md, "How this is tested"`.
[119] `gpu/ecc/fp256.cuh`.
[120] `gpu/ecc/point.cuh`.
[121] `gpu/ecc/README.md`.

Table 10: Static PTX instruction counts for one 256-bit field multiplication (clang, `sm_90`, `-O3`). The hard floor for the product is 128 instructions: 64 limb products at two instructions each. Class: engineering; nothing here has executed on a device.

	portable C++	inline PTX, before	inline PTX, after
512-bit product	236	171	137
secp256k1 reduction	146	130	77
full multiply	472	328	**210**
Montgomery CIOS multiply	475	—	352

Table 10 is the instruction ledger. The portable path emits no carry instructions at all: of the 444 instructions in a portable squaring, 178 are adds, 102 shifts, 100 ANDs and only 46 multiplies, so the multiply is carry-bound, not multiply-bound, and the inline-PTX rewrite's 55% cut comes from the carry chains. The seven assembly blocks are checked by an interpreter against the portable path on 20,000 random and boundary inputs each, and that check is mutation-tested; it does not cover register allocation or device semantics, which is why `FP_PTX` is off by default.[122][123]

In the unit of Section 4, a secp256k1 inversion is 270 multiplications (255 squarings and 15 multiplications along the libsecp256k1 addition chain), a rho step with batch W is $6 + 270/W$ multiplications (3 for the affine addition, 3 for Montgomery's trick), $7 + 270/W$ with the $j = 0$ fold: 39.8 at $W = 8$, 14.4 at $W = 32$, 8.1 at $W = 128$, against 276 unbatched.[124] Three things were tried and declined on the static count: a dedicated squaring routine (-2.7% portable, $+23.5\%$ on the PTX path; reverted), lazy reduction to $[0, 2^{256})$ (worth about 10% of a multiply, but it breaks the canonical form that equality, the distinguished-point test, the cycle hash and the fold comparison rely on), and Karatsuba (judged to lose on a carry-bound multiply). Tensor cores were considered and not reached for.[125] Marking the inversion and ladder routines `__noinline__` and replacing two 16-entry tables by a small double-scalar ladder took the walk kernel's stack from 4,664 to 1,616 B (the low-memory variant from 4,008 to 792 B) and the compile from over ten minutes to 46 s, the same code-size lesson as Section 4.1.[126]

8.3 Rho with automorphism folding, and baby-step giant-step

The rho walk is r-adding on the low bits of x, with distinguished points by a mask on the next byte and three folds: identity, the negation map, and on $j = 0$ curves the full $\langle \beta, -1 \rangle$ orbit of order six, chosen by minimising x over $\{x, \beta x, \beta^2 x\}$ at the cost of one multiplication ($\beta^2 x = -(x + \beta x)$) and two compares, about 10% of a batched step for $\sqrt{3}$ fewer steps. Only an automorphism code is kept per step; a report is $\{x, \text{walk}, \text{restart}, \text{steps}\}$, 48 bytes, and the host replays the two colliding walks from their seeds, multiplying (a, b) by $(-1)^{\text{neg}} \lambda^k$ at each step. Fruitless cycles of length 2 to 6 are detected with a five-deep ring and escaped by doubling the member with the smallest hash; their measured rates at $R = 8$ agree with the prediction to about 10%.[127]

On a 36-bit $j = 0$ toy curve in host emulation (8 solves per fold, 16 walks, $R = 256$, period 2^7), the mean steps were 305,740, 199,042 and 113,522 for folds 1, 2 and 6 against predictions of 249,454, 176,391 and 101,839 (1.23×, 1.13×, 1.11×; ±0.18× on a mean of eight), all 8/8 correct, so fold 6 buys 1.75× over the negation map (predicted 1.73). In the unit $S = \text{ops}/\sqrt{n}$ that

[122] `gpu/ecc/OPTIMIZATION_BLACKWELL.md, Âğ2.`
[123] `gpu/ecc/ptx_asm_check.py.`
[124] `gpu/ecc/OPTIMIZATION_BLACKWELL.md, Âğ1.`
[125] `gpu/ecc/OPTIMIZATION_BLACKWELL.md, Âğ2 and Âğ4.4.`
[126] `gpu/ecc/OPTIMIZATION_BLACKWELL.md, Âğ3.`
[127] `gpu/ecc/README.md, "The walk".`

Table 11: Rho and baby-step giant-step on a 40-bit toy curve ($n = 649{,}523{,}094{,}257$), host emulation of the device source, 128 chains, mean over 8 random targets. S = group additions/$\sqrt{n}$ with table construction charged. The rho rows predate the order-six fold and were single solves ($\pm 0.5\times$). Twelve targets on a 2^{26} interval cost $S = 0.560$ per target against 2.131 for one cold solve.

row	table/$\sqrt{n}$	mean S	predicted	correct
rho, negation map (reference)	0	0.85	—	1/1
rho, no negation map	0	1.42	—	1/1
BSGS textbook, reference stepper	0.707	1.44	1.41	21/21
BSGS textbook, batched $W = 16$	0.707	1.44 (bit-identical)	1.41	21/21
BSGS negation layout, $W = 16$	0.500	1.07	1.00	21/21
giant phase only	0.500	0.56	0.50	8/8

is 1.54, 1.00 and 0.57. The three steppers (batched, low-memory, one-inversion-per-walk) are bit-identical over hundreds of iterations with the same distinguished-point multiset, and every point replays on the host to $aP + bQ$, which is what proves the λ bookkeeping on secp256k1 itself.[128]

Baby-step giant-step on the same arithmetic keeps an x-keyed table of 16-byte entries in lock-free open addressing (one 64-bit `atomicCAS` per probe, about 2.5 slots per probe at half load, a false-candidate rate of load/2^{32} and none observed), and walks W giant chains per thread sharing one inversion, 94 registers and no spills at $W = 8$. With the negation map the layout is $m = \sqrt{w}/2$ babies and $2m - 1$ giants, the Galbraith–Wang–Zhang row at $1.00\sqrt{w}$ expected against the textbook $1.41\sqrt{w}$. A 2^{66}-wide interval is 2^{32} entries and 64 GB, the top of one 80 GB device; beyond that the method is out of memory, not out of time.[129] Table 11 is the measured cost on a 40-bit toy curve, in emulation, every phase charged.

The classification is the same as every row in Section 5: the batched stepper is engineering, the layouts are the published ones, and nothing moves the ratio to the generic floor. A Rust port of the same baby-step giant-step on the CPU runs at 37–49 M steps/s on four threads at $S = 1.03$ cold and 0.55 amortised, 6–11× the big-integer implementation it replaced.[130] The emulation itself runs at about 380 k steps/s per core, a figure that says nothing about a device and is quoted only so that no one mistakes it for one.

8.4 Pollard kangaroo for the interval problem

The interval solver reuses the verified field and point code for $Q = kG$ with $k \in [a, a+w)$ at about $2\sqrt{w}$ steps: two herds that alternate by thread parity so every warp is half tame and half wild, a jump table of 2^6 pseudo-random scalars with mean jump $\sqrt{w}/2$ and 25-word entries (odd, so the shared-memory reads are bank-conflict-free), and the target centred at $Q' = Q - (a + w/2)G$. The invariant that makes it testable is that after every step a tame kangaroo at distance d is at dG and a wild one at $Q' + dG$, which pins the jump table, the distance accumulator and the point arithmetic together.[131]

Its measured constant is the useful number. In emulation on a 2^{31} interval with 120 trials per configuration, steps are $C\sqrt{w}$ with $C = 2.79 \pm 0.13$ for the default (median 2.65); the idealised two-herd bound is 2.0, Pollard's classic lambda about 3.3, and published parallel implementations about 2.1, so this one is about a third above the best published. A jump-parameter sweep at 20 trials per cell had shown C from 2.50 to 3.95, an apparent 36% win;

[128] `gpu/ecc/README.md, "How this is tested"`.
[129] `gpu/ecc/README.md, "Baby-step giant-step"`.
[130] `gpu/ecc/README.md, "Cost, measured"`.
[131] `gpu/btcpuzzle/README.md, "How the walk works"`.

rerun at 120 trials the best cell and the default were within half a standard error. The defaults sit on a flat optimum and the sweep was noise, which is recorded so that it is not rediscovered. Restarting at a distinguished point or not was likewise within noise.[132] A multi-device split (one host thread per device, disjoint even index bases so herd parity stays global, one host table) is tested by reproducing the combined herd exactly from two contexts and recovering a 28-bit key across them; multi-machine is not done.[133] The tool ships no real puzzle keys (no trustworthy offline source), does no address scanning, and has not solved any puzzle; the synthetic 20-, 28- and 32-bit registry entries are regression fixtures.

8.5 P-256 and P-384: the one that has since run

The NIST library has graduated from this inventory: it now has device measurements, and Section 7 reports them as the ECC2K-130 ladder carried over to prime fields. One historical note belongs here. The library's first device attempt was an infrastructure non-result, because the cloud credentials were not exposed to the CI runner and the GPU steps were skipped. The attempt record says it "must not be cited as performance evidence", and we do not cite it.[134]

8.6 Binary fields beyond ECC2K-130

The ECC2K-95 kernel. Section 2.3 used this kernel as the end-to-end control; its arithmetic is the packed, polynomial-basis counterpart of Section 4.2. An element is four 32-bit words; a 32-bit carry-less product is sixteen widening integer multiplies with the interleaved-mask trick (operands split by bit index modulo 4 so no partial sum exceeds 8 and nothing carries); the 1-bit top word at $m = 97$ is split off so that a three-way Karatsuba over three words (six leaves) plus seven single-bit masks replaces nine leaves; reduction by $t^{97} + t^6 + 1$ is two folds, the second an extract and two XORs; squaring is a bit-spread kept in 64-bit form (78 instructions against 104 for two 32-bit spreads); inversion is Itoh–Tsujii at about 7 multiplications and 96 squarings. The static count is 304 instructions per multiplication, down from 405, with the six software leaves 96 of the 304; the native `clmad` that gave the ECC2K-130 client +22% would do the same product in six instructions and is not yet ported because the pip-wheel toolchain stops at `ptxas` 12.9.[135][136]

Per step the cost model is one inversion split W ways plus two multiplications, one squaring and the three multiplications of Montgomery's trick, with the two Frobenius chains of the walk paid in squarings: 3,813 instructions at $W = 8$, 44% multiplies, 27% the Frobenius chains, 25% the inversion's squarings. Because τ^k is $\mathbb{F}_2$-linear it can be applied as 25 four-bit-window table reads at any k, 296 instructions against 78 per squaring; tables for $\tau^{6,12,24,48}$ cut the inversion's 3,744 squaring instructions at $k = 48$ to 296 and the step to 3,083 (-19%), and $W = 4$ with tables beats $W = 8$ without at 656 against 1,048 bytes of local memory. The table traffic, 400 words per inversion, is unmeasured, and the tables are off by default.[137] The low-memory stepper at $W = 8$ compiles to 128 registers and 464 B of stack with four blocks per SM, 512 threads per SM on `sm_90`, `sm_100` and `sm_120`; the prime-field walk of Section 8.2 needs 226 registers and 792 B at 256 threads per SM, so the binary walk gets 1.5–2× the occupancy before either has run.[138] A 40-bit end-to-end test of eight logarithms on one CPU core fell from 2.1–2.7 s to 1.02–1.05 s across the rewrite at the same 191,840 steps, which the README itself files as engineering with S flat.

[132] `gpu/btcpuzzle/README.md, "Measured cost"`.
[133] `gpu/btcpuzzle/README.md, "Multi-GPU"`.
[134] `research/nist_gpu_arithmetic_20260926/ATTEMPT.md`.
[135] `gpu/ecc2k/README.md, "What the field arithmetic actually costs"`.
[136] `gpu/ecc2k/f2m.cuh`.
[137] `gpu/ecc2k/README.md, "$\tau ^k$ is not $k$ squarings"`.
[138] `gpu/ecc2k/README.md, "Occupancy"`.

The pair table. For Koblitz index calculus the same directory builds the meet-in-the-middle table of all $P_i + P_j$ over a factor base, one thread per row with the row's denominators batch-inverted, folded to signed Frobenius orbits by the least cyclic rotation of x in a normal basis (one representative times an orbit-sorted suffix, $2n$ times fewer sums). Stored words shrink 43.4× at $n = 23$ (6,256 against 271,216) and 77.2× at $n = 41$ (11,152 against 861,328). Verification runs each emulated thread on its own CPU thread, requires identical tables at several thread counts and chunkings, round-trips every stored pair and 19,999 generator multiples into the Rust table, keeps a control that must lose pairs, and runs under ThreadSanitizer with a deliberately racy control that must be reported; the bug that motivated all this (the base size passed as the field degree) fails 960 of 1,176 keys when restored.[139][140] The fold does not reach $n = 97$ (limited to $n \leq 62$) and the device round trip is planned, not run.

Polynomial systems. Two more kernels serve the decomposition step of Section 11.1. A Gray-code fast exhaustive search over quadratic Boolean systems (one thread per sub-cube, $n \leq 40$, ≤ 64 equations, shards checked against brute force) exists alongside the production Rust path and has not run on a device.[141] A Semaev S_4 pairs-and-solve sweep (fix X_1, X_2, reduce the quartic in X_3 against the linearised polynomial of the factor-base subspace, $O(l)$ field operations per pair instead of 2^l) has a `clmad` path and a software fallback, is tested against exhaustive triple enumeration, and on one host core went from 5.07 to 0.44 ms per 2^l-row sweep at $n = 21$. Its README's conclusion is the one that matters: relation collection stays $\Theta(2^n)$ with any oracle polynomial in the base, "the oracle got roughly a thousand times faster and the attack's exponent did not move"; a GPU is another constant. The same README records and retracts an earlier claim that NVIDIA has no carry-less multiply.[142]

Linear algebra. A batched dense reduced-echelon solver over $\mathbb{F}_p$ ($p = 2083$, 226×286 matrices of rank 222) serves the $E(\mathbb{F}_{p^3})$ index calculus whose Macaulay step is 57% of each solve. One archived pipeline experiment did run on an RTX PRO 4500: 64 matrices per invocation, 36 runs, 2,340 matrices verified against the serial reduction, device reduction about 0.045 s per batch inside a 0.32 s cold invocation dominated by setup, and a two-slot overlap 5.1% faster on held-out seeds, which the record declines to call a speedup for want of an exclusive host and an interval. Its own conclusion is that a GPU changes the crossover with rho "by not a single bit"; it would only enable larger p.[143][144] (The directory README's statement that no kernel has run on a GPU predates that experiment.) A sparse matrix–vector worker modulo any $m < 2^{63}$ is correctness-first, every product rechecked on the CPU, with no rate.[145]

8.7 What did run: F4 elimination on rented GPUs

The sibling library's F4 Gröbner-basis path for Weil-descent systems is the one piece of index-calculus arithmetic with device measurements. On a rented RTX 5090 (`sm_120`, 32 GB) the degree-6 Macaulay matrices are built and eliminated 25 to 75 times faster than on the Xeon host; the 168,363 × 188,203 matrix went from 426 s to 5.7 s, the degree-of-regularity sweep from 18.8 to 8.2 s, and the batched per-node decider was correct on the device and 4.4× slower than the host's default engine.[146] On an H100 a tiled update to the elimination kernel was kept at 1.11–1.49× and a merged-basis panel reverted at 1.5–5.3× slower; the largest matrix fell from

[139] `gpu/ecc2k/README.md, "The $|F|^2$ pair table".`
[140] `gpu/ecc2k/pairtable.cuh.`
[141] `gpu/fes/README.md.`
[142] `gpu/semaev/README.md.`
[143] `gpu/macaulay/README.md.`
[144] `gpu/macaulay/benchmarks/pipeline-20260914/RESULTS.md.`
[145] `gpu/spmv/README.md.`
[146] `cryptanalysis:experiments/f4-gpu-runpod-20261006/RESULT.md.`

4,781 to 3,586 ms.[147] The records call these what they are, stage diagnostics of one oracle matrix, not an ECDLP cost, and a later crossover harness keeps its qualified speedup null until a matched device-and-host resource receipt exists.[148]

The sibling's own 64-bit prime-field CUDA rho (one limb, Montgomery with $R = 2^{64}$, eight walks per thread sharing a Fermat inversion so that a step is 18 multiplications instead of 99) is in the same state as the kernels above: 77,000 device-arithmetic assertions against the host library, whole-solver emulation on four groups, a cubin for `sm_70` through `sm_90` with 64–72 registers and no spills, and no execution on a device; its emulator rows sit at $S \approx 1.3$–2.6 alongside the CPU rho and show only that S does not grow with the walk count.[149][150] Its efficiency scorer, built for the ECC2K-130 walk, is the one place the two threads meet: charging the packed walk's 4,328 lane-instructions per iteration to the measured dual-issue rate of the RTX PRO 6000 (78.3 per SM-clock, 188 SMs, 2,307 MHz) gives an attainable 7.85 billion iterations/s per card against an audited 6.905 for that build, 88% of the issue roof, and the same method on the wide multiply reproduces the "31 billion iterations/s if the walk did nothing else" of the earlier ceiling note.[151][152]

8.8 What the inventory says

Two lessons hold across the fields. The first is that, on this hardware, the carry-less unit is the whole difference between the binary and prime-field kernels. A 131-bit binary product is six `CLMAD`, while a 256-bit prime-field product is at best 210 carry-chained integer instructions. The binary walk is therefore limited by a narrow unit at 1.6–2.0 lanes per SM-clock, the prime-field walk by carries on the wide integer pipe, and the two want different occupancies, batch sizes and arithmetic representations. Section 7 confirms this on a device: the same levers helped both walks, but by very different amounts. The second lesson is that each of these libraries reached a verified, bit-identical, statically accounted state without ever touching a device, and that state is worth exactly what Section 5.1 says a pre-tuning floor is worth. It bounds what a device could do; it does not tell you what one did. The NIST walk is a reminder of how wide that gap can be: its first device run measured an empty kernel. Only the ECC2K-130 client and, more recently, the NIST walk have crossed to the measured side, which is why they get sections of their own and the rest share this one.

9 The FPGA engine

In some ways this field suits an FPGA better than a GPU. The GPU has one narrow carry-less unit per SM, while an FPGA can be filled with carry-less multipliers, and σ^k is just wiring. We designed a VHDL engine for the AWS F2 (Xilinx VU47P), estimated its rate before any board time, and then measured it.

9.1 Estimate before the board

Before synthesis, we mapped the client's own straight-line multiplier to LUT6s (about 5,563 at 32 levels, known to be about 40% high for ignoring dual-output packing) and calibrated against the 3,071 and 3,620 LUTs that Bernstein et al. report for GF(2^{113}) and GF(2^{127}) multipliers [7], extrapolated to 3,781 at $m = 131$. With multipliers at 79% of a core and 5.33 multipliers per core, a core is 25.5 KLUT at literature packing or 37.5 KLUT with the repository's unpacked

[147] `cryptanalysis:experiments/f4-gpu-panel-20261007/README.md`.
[148] `cryptanalysis:experiments/f4-gpu-query-20261008/README.md`.
[149] `cryptanalysis:docs/GPU.md`.
[150] `cryptanalysis:docs/BENCHMARKS.md, "GPU rho kernel"`.
[151] `cryptanalysis:gpueff/README.md`.
[152] `cryptanalysis:gpueff/profiles/ecc2k130-packed-walk.json`.

Table 12: Simulated clocks per step of the batched step unit at multiplier latency 10, against the arithmetic bound $5 + 5/W$. The default geometry is 64×8 (512 walks per engine), which runs at 5.16 clocks per step with either multiplier.

W	batches in flight	200 steps	6,144 steps	bound
8	8	8.02	6.62	5.63
16	4	9.86	8.38	5.31
16	8	6.98	5.67	5.31
16	16	6.46	5.34	5.31
32	8	7.20	5.20	5.16

circuit; 18% shell overhead on 1,303,680 CLB LUTs at 70–80% utilisation gives 29–34 or 20–23 cores at an estimated 250–350 MHz. The estimate came to 5–12 billion iterations/s per VU47P, with a central value of 8 billion iterations/s: slower per chip than the 14.1 billion iterations/s GPU, roughly level on cost per solve, and 2–5× better per watt.[153]

9.2 Design

Multiplier. `gf131_mul` follows the Bernstein–Lange route in hardware: `prep` converts each operand to the polynomial basis (991 XOR2 per operand), a recursive Karatsuba `gf2_kmul` splits $131 \to 66 \to 33 \to 17$ bits into 27 leaf products of 17×17, and `to_onb` converts the 261-coefficient product back (3,167 XOR2). There is no reduction step. At three levels the product is 7,803 AND and 9,404 XOR2, 14,553 XOR2 per multiply including conversions, against 17,161 AND and 22,049 XOR2 for schoolbook. Out of context in Vivado 2025.2 at a 4.0 ns clock, three levels map to 4,855 LUTs and 4,647 FFs with +2.68 ns of slack.[154]

A DSP leaf computes a 17-bit GF(2) product as six 25×16 integer products with coefficients spaced three bits apart (split $9 + 8$ against $6 + 6 + 5$) so that no column count exceeds six and nothing carries; the parities are XORed into place with 22 LUTs. Eleven of the 27 leaves go to DSPs, 66 DSP48E2 per multiplier, which takes the multiplier to 4,004 LUTs at a latency of 14 clocks including a 261-FF copy register (11 clocks with LUT leaves). The pblock holds 7,992 DSPs, so 120 engines can take 11 DSP leaves and 128 engines ten.[155][156]

Step and batch. An unbatched step is ten multiplies: $d = x + \sigma^j x$, $\lambda = (y + \sigma^j y)/d$ with the eight-multiply Itoh–Tsujii inversion, $x_3 = \lambda^2 + \lambda + d$, $y_3 = \lambda(x + x_3) + x_3 + y$. `ec2k_batch_pipe` shares one inversion across W walks through a product tree held in UltraRAM (four URAM288 per engine): $W - 1$ forward multiplies, 8 for the inversion, $2(W - 1)$ backward, W for λ and W for y_3, $5W + 5$ per batch, $5 + 5/W$ per step: 5.31 at $W = 16$, 5.16 at $W = 32$, 5.08 at $W = 64$. A batch is a chain of $2 \log_2 W + 10$ bursts, and several batches are kept in flight to hide the multiplier latency. Table 12 is the simulated rate.[157][158]

Walker and host port. Walks live in a block-RAM FIFO of $(\mathrm{id}, \mathrm{steps}, x, y, \mathrm{dp})$, 285 bits by 512, read through a four-entry prefetch. Only the low 13 bits of the step count travel with the walk; the high 19 sit in a LUTRAM table bumped once every 8,192 steps. A step whose x has weight at most `DP_WEIGHT` is flagged, moves into a report register at the FIFO head and is held until acknowledged, so no report is ever lost and the `DROPPED` counter always reads zero.

[153] `ecc2k130/FPGA-CEILING.md`.
[154] `hdl/ecc2k130/README.md`.
[155] `hdl/ecc2k130/gf2_dsp_leaf.vhd`.
[156] `hdl/ecc2k130/README.md`.
[157] `hdl/ecc2k130/ec2k_batch_pipe.vhd`.
[158] `hdl/ecc2k130/README.md`.

Table 13: F2 images on one VU47P (`f2.6xlarge`). All runs had zero dropped reports; for every image except the 112- and 120-engine ones, 32 or 64 sampled distinguished points were re-walked on the host against the client reference from the same seed and matched. The 128-engine image is the promoted AFI.

engines	MHz	geometry	routed WNS (ns)	million it/s	clk/step
48	333.3	16×16, tree in BRAM	+0.022	3,010.7	5.31
64	333.3	same	+0.040	4,013.7	5.32
80	333.3	17 tiles/engine	+0.027	5,015.8	5.32
96	333.3	same	+0.002	6,018.0	5.32
112	375	32×8, tree in URAM	+0.049	8,123	5.17
120	333.3	32×8, tree in URAM	+0.063	7,730	5.17
128	**333.3**	32×8, tree in URAM, LUT multiplier	+0.048	**8,249**	**5.17**

`ec2k_axil` is an AXI4-Lite slave in front of `NENG` walkers with a credit-based register spine (about 870 FFs and 300 LUTs per engine), introduced after the first flat 48-engine build placed at −2.5 ns. The host program is a drop-in for the CUDA client under the same worker script: it writes the same 32-byte records and can re-walk the first N reports from their seeds on the CPU (`-verify N`); production workers leave verification to the campaign merge.[159][160]

Verification. The reference script imports the client's field model and emits 256 multiplier vectors (including 0, the all-ones 1, single basis elements and the extreme coordinates, each also checked against an independent direct convolution), 200 steps (twelve full batches of 16 plus a partial batch, so the flush path runs every time) and 64 walks of random order-ℓ points on the challenge curve. The batch testbench passes for every W from 2 to 32 with 2 to 16 batches in flight; the walker testbench checks every report's id, step count and point against the reference trajectory (64 distinguished points from 797 steps in 19,194 clocks).[161][162]

9.3 Measured on `f2.6xlarge`

Table 13 lists every image we built, placed, loaded and timed, and Figure 2 plots them.[163] The 48-engine run read back its geometry (48 engines of 512 walks, weight 34, 333.3 MHz), seeded 24,576 walks over AXI-Lite in 7.3 s, held 3,010 million iterations/s from ten seconds on, and completed 103 billion iterations in a 40 s run; simulation had predicted 5.29 clocks per step against the measured 5.31. The promoted 128-engine image holds 8.25 billion iterations/s. A design whose engines share nothing but the host port should scale linearly with engine count, and the measured images sit on that line. Builds that missed timing (128 engines at 375 MHz, 112 at 400) and the 144-engine build that failed block-RAM placement (3,744 RAMB18 sites needed against 3,576) are recorded alongside; the projection at 5.16 clocks per step is 8.8 billion iterations/s at 136 engines and 9.3 at 144 or at 128 engines and 375 MHz, neither yet met (128 at 375 MHz routed at −0.21 ns; 144 failed placement).[164]

Per engine the current revision is 6,790–6,940 LUTs, 9,371 FFs, 12 RAMB36, 4 URAM and 66 DSPs; the 96-engine image used 62% of the LUTs and 81% of the block RAM, and block RAM, not logic, is what bounds the engine count on this part.[165]

[159] `hdl/ecc2k130/ec2k_walker.vhd`.
[160] `hdl/ecc2k130/host/ecc2k130_fpga.cpp`.
[161] `hdl/ecc2k130/ecc2k_ref.py`.
[162] `hdl/ecc2k130/vectors_ecc2k130.txt`.
[163] `hdl/ecc2k130/aws/README.md`.
[164] `hdl/ecc2k130/README.md`.
[165] `hdl/ecc2k130/README.md`.

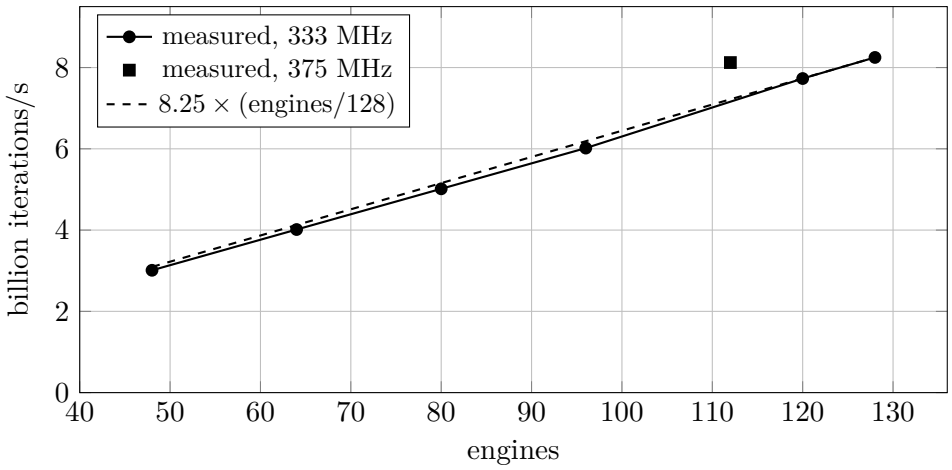


Figure 2: ECC2K-130 FPGA engine on AWS F2. The 128-engine image at 333 MHz is 8.25 billion iterations/s; the pre-board estimate was 5–12 billion iterations/s with a central 8. The measurement landed on the central estimate; it is a device measurement, not the estimate restated.

9.4 F2 against the GPU

At the prices observed on 2026-09-11, an F2 instance at $1.980 on demand or $0.709 spot against an RTX PRO 6000 at $4.14 and $1.31 per GPU-hour, the expected $2^{60.9}$ iterations cost about 72,400 F2-hours at the measured 8.25 billion iterations/s, roughly $51k spot, against 42,400 GPU-hours and $56k spot at the campaign's 14.11 billion iterations/s collection rate.[166] So the two platforms are level on cost per solve, within the noise of spot pricing, and the FPGA is about 2–5× better per watt on the note's estimated power envelopes (75–150 W against a 600 W board). FPGA workers follow the same client contract as the GPUs and write the same records, so a collision between an FPGA trail and a GPU trail is merged like any other.

10 The campaign

At the campaign's collection rate, $2^{60.9}$ iterations is about five years on a single GPU. The campaign is therefore not a single solve but a collection effort: a corpus of distinguished points, each re-walkable from its seed, grown on whatever hardware is cheapest at the time and merged as it arrives. This section covers its configuration, its calibration, its storage protocol and where it stands now.

10.1 Configuration

The configuration is one file in the repository; the copy in the storage bucket is what workers read.[167][168] Walk: σ (Section 3.1). `dpWeight`: 32, uniform campaign-wide, and a campaign run refuses any other. Batch 16, 256-thread blocks, two resident blocks per SM, 385,024 workers = 6,160,384 logical walks per GPU, 1,024 steps per launch, checkpoint and upload every 600 s, restart every 48 h. The iteration guard `maxIters` in the repository file is 2^{32}, twelve trail lengths at weight 32; it was 2^{30}, three trail lengths, which a model on the measured rates says cut 4.9% of walks and discarded 15.6% of the fleet's steps until an audit found it. Whether the bucket

[166] Derived here from the measured rate and the prices recorded in `ecc2k130/FPGA-CEILING.md`; the note's own table priced the hypothetical 8 billion iterations/s image at $53k spot.

[167] `ecc2k130/aws/campaign.json`.

[168] `ecc2k130/aws/README.md`.

Table 14: Iterations per distinguished point at cutoff 32, frozen 2026-09-17 18:47 UTC. Per-worker spread 0.04 in the exponent. The last column is the median self-reported rate of the family's workers on the same day.

family	workers	iterations	points	it/point	median billion it/s
RTX PRO 6000 (g7e)	38	$5.606 \cdot 10^{15}$	15,724,672	$2^{28.41}$	14.66
L40S (g6e)	34	$2.723 \cdot 10^{15}$	7,643,600	$2^{28.41}$	7.47
RTX PRO 4500 (g7)	48	$3.081 \cdot 10^{15}$	8,640,973	$2^{28.41}$	4.87
CPU	12	$2.804 \cdot 10^{14}$	785,410	$2^{28.41}$	2.29
all	132	$1.169 \cdot 10^{16}$	32,794,655	$\mathbf{2^{28.41}}$	$\approx$ 1,068 total

copy was raised before the fleet stopped is not recorded.[169] The fields that define the corpus (workers, batch, geometry, curve, cutoff, walk and the state-layout knobs) freeze once any slot exists; `WITNESS=0` is pinned. The preset is the audited RTX PRO 6000 build at CUDA 13.3.1 and `sm_120`.[170] A checkpoint is about 370 MB (six million walks at 60 bytes).

10.2 Cutoff 32 and the interval $2^{28.41}$

The planning numbers follow from the cutoff.[171] At weight 34 the expected corpus is $2^{35.6}$ records, about 1.7 TB, one per $2^{25.27}$ iterations; at weight 32 one report per $2^{28.41}$ iterations, $2^{3.14} = 8.8\times$ rarer, so about $2^{32.5}$ records and 0.19 TB at the expected work, about 40 points/s, 3.4 M points/day and 0.11 GB/day from a GPU collecting at 14.11 billion iterations/s. The price of a rarer point is the work left in flight when a collision lands: 43 GPU-hours per GPU at weight 32 (6.16 M walks times $2^{28.41}$ steps), 13% of the expected work at 128 GPUs and more than the whole expected work at 1,024, against 4.9 GPU-hours per GPU at weight 34. The campaign's fleet size never approached the range where that trade reverses.

We measured the interval twice, and the first measurement was wrong. A fleet-wide ratio of $7.93 \cdot 10^{15}$ checkpointed iterations to 31.6 M uploaded points on 2026-09-15 had been quoted as $2^{27.9}$ iterations per point. Neither counter was clean: the checkpoint sum multiplied every slot's per-walk base by the Blackwell grid constant, inflating the auto-sized Ada slots by the ratio of the grids (about 26× on an L4-sized grid), and the point total mixed in two retired slots that had walked at weight 34. The replacement reads from each live worker the client's own two counters, iterations this run on the grid the client built itself and points reported over the same interval, frozen at 2026-09-17 18:47 UTC across 132 workers (Table 14).[172] The result, $2^{28.41} = 3.56 \cdot 10^8$, is the same on every hardware family to 0.04 in the exponent, and sits $2^{0.60}$ below the naive binomial $P(\mathrm{HW} \le 32) = 2^{-29.01}$, as Bailey et al.'s $2^{25.27}$ sits $2^{0.57}$ below the binomial at weight 34. We classify the correction as accounting: the walk did not change, only the number did, and we retire the earlier figure rather than averaging it in.

10.3 Fleet economics

The total cost depends on the work, not on the size of the fleet: at the 2026-09-11 spot price of $1.31 per RTX PRO 6000 hour the expected 42,400 GPU-hours are about $56k whether 8 GPUs take 221 days or 512 take 3.4; on demand the figure is $142k–$175k.[173] What fleet size changes is the calendar, and the in-flight loss described above. The campaign ran mixed families because iterations per dollar, not iterations per card, is the objective: on 2026-09-18

[169] `research/ecc2k130_rho_audit_20260925/README.md`.
[170] `ecc2k130/aws/README.md`.
[171] `ecc2k130/aws/README.md, "The numbers that decide the plan"`.
[172] `ecc2k130/benchmarks/dp-interval/README.md`.
[173] `ecc2k130/aws/README.md`.

the best-value quote was an L4 in `eu-north-1` at $56 \cdot 10^{12}$ iterations per dollar against $38 \cdot 10^{12}$ for the RTX PRO 6000 and $28 \cdot 10^{12}$ for the RTX PRO 4500, and at that quote a full reference walk costs about $38k.[174] The per-SKU rates behind those ratios are measured, not list: L40S 8.84 billion iterations/s with `clmad`, L4 2.49, T4 0.53 without it.[175][176]

The RTX PRO 4500 is the most instructive case. Its measured 5.107 billion iterations/s on the shipping walk is exactly what the 6000's rate predicts from SM count and clock ($14.64 \times 82/188 \times 1.95/2.44 = 5.10$), and at that rate the 6000 wins per dollar by 1.2–1.3×; the break-even against the 6000's shipping rate is 6.2–6.6 billion iterations/s in the two cheapest regions and 8.8 in the third, figures the note says must be redone with both cards on their best builds.[177] That is why a 12 billion iterations/s goal was set for the card and why the x-only bridge map of Section 3.3 was pursued there rather than on the 6000: a power-capped die rewards fewer instructions per step more than a pipe-bound one does. The separate goal of 28 billion iterations/s on one 6000 was priced below the pipe (Section 5.1) and its grid and occupancy screens, run on an RTX PRO 4500 because no 6000 could be allocated, found nothing faster than the shipping configuration.[178]

A power survey closes the loop: on the 6000 the 20 billion iterations/s build drew 583 W for 34.4 M updates per joule and a fused-pass variant 544 W for 37.0 M/J in the same session, 1.072× per joule in five paired repetitions against a 1.03 target; per joule, not per second, is the figure that transfers to a 165 W card, and the model, calibrated on the 4500's 5.107 and 5.552 billion iterations/s receipts (ratio error +2.6%), predicts 7.2–7.4 billion iterations/s for the fused build there.[179] That prediction still needs a measurement; the bridge map got there first.

10.4 Storage, seeds and certification

A record is 32 bytes: a little-endian 64-bit seed and the canonical normal-basis x of the endpoint, three 64-bit words; no scalar coefficients are stored, they are rebuilt by replay. The seed is `run id (16)` ‖ `walk index (32)` ‖ `restart counter (16)` with run id = slot +1; a splitmix64 finaliser expands it to the 128-bit c of the start point. Two contributors who pick different run ids never start the same walk (independently seeded walks can still meet, which is the point), and a permanent seed registry does compare-and-set across providers (Modal GPU runs are ids 8000–8999, CPU sidecars 9000–9999); a race test with eight claimants acquired exactly one.[180][181][182][183]

Uploads are ordered so that no pointer ever names data that is not there: payloads before their commit manifests, both before checkpoint publication. Strict manifests bind curve, cutoff, guard, seed and key semantics, worker geometry, source hash, worker binary hash and replay binary hash, and every immutable payload carries its SHA-256. Slot ownership is one S3 object per slot claimed with a conditional put on the ETag, a 60 s heartbeat and a 180 s lease; checkpoints are content-addressed and the owner-checked heartbeat publishes the pointer, so a stale worker can leave orphaned blobs but cannot commit. The note is explicit that this is integrity against failure, not authentication against an actor able to rewrite both data and

[174] `ecc2k130/aws/RESEARCH-CREDITS.md`.
[175] `ecc2k130/ADA-L4-L40S.md`.
[176] `ecc2k130/T4-G4DN.md`.
[177] `ecc2k130/RTX-PRO4500.md`.
[178] `ecc2k130/GOAL28-RESULTS.md`.
[179] `ecc2k130/POWER-BOUND.md`.
[180] `ecc2k130/CERTIFICATION.md`.
[181] `ecc2k130/SEED-IDENTITY.md`.
[182] `research/ecc2k130_rho_audit_20260925/README.md, "Seeds"`.
[183] `ecc2k130/aws/README.md`.

manifests.[184][185]

Merging buckets records by a hash of the key limbs (the first layout used the key's low bits) into 4,096 files, sorts, drops exact duplicates (the client store, the database primary key and the merge are three layers; 9.95 M re-reports had been dropped by 2026-09-25) and reports equal keys with different seeds. Such a pair goes into a two-record file and to the CPU client, which re-walks both trails, aligns Frobenius and negation, and verifies $[k]P = Q$; a $\mathrm{GF}(2^{41})$ pair with known seeds that recovers $k = 369250562913$ is the local acceptance fixture. An exhaustive check of 76,904,684 step multisets confirms that no multiset of at most 32 σ-walk steps closes an orbit, so no short fruitless cycle exists; a trail crossing itself at random is estimated at about 2^{-65} per trail, about 10^{-10} over the campaign, and the iteration guard releases such a walk.[186][187][188]

The public dashboard publishes aggregates only: not point keys, coefficients, seeds or database locations.[189][190]

10.5 State

The campaign was created on 2026-09-11. Its fleet on 2026-09-17 was about 133 workers (the 132 with enough points to calibrate are in Table 14), producing about 2,600 points/s by the ingest's count; the ingest path was re-engineered that week from one object at a time (2,450 records/s, below production) to a threaded loader measured at 137,753 rows/s, and a five-and-a-half-hour blind spot during a key layout change was recovered in 23 minutes (4,321 objects, 63,351,803 rows, zero failed), taking the store from 67.6 M to 124.3 M points.[191] On 2026-09-18 the spot market reclaimed every worker and the cloud account was placed on an account-verification (risk) hold that has blocked new instance launches since; collection continued at a small scale on another provider. Its first four GPU runs reused the run ids of the first four slots by mistake and re-walked them (813k of one run's 912k records byte-identical to the slot they replayed, all dropped as re-reports, and an inadvertent end-to-end replay check); later runs use the reserved ids 8000–8999.[192][193]

Table 15 gives two snapshots: the audited one of 2026-09-25, while a small fleet was still walking, and the published feed of 2026-10-10, by which time the last point had landed (2026-10-07) and no slot was walking; the sustained peak and the mean trail length in the caption are from the audit.[194][195][196] Having no collision yet is exactly what we should expect: $2^{56.68}$ iterations is 5.4% of $2^{60.9}$, and the probability of no collision after a fraction c of the expected work is about $\exp(-\pi c^2/4)$, here 0.998. Collection is paused, not finished: every slot's checkpoint and the corpus are intact, and a worker that resumes a slot continues its walks from the checkpoint.

11 Structural alternatives, measured

Everything above is engineering against a fixed exponent. Three lines of work asked, in the same accounting, whether the exponent itself could move for this curve. We report each with

[184] `ecc2k130/CERTIFICATION.md`.
[185] `ecc2k130/aws/README.md`, "Slots".
[186] `ecc2k130/CERTIFICATION.md`.
[187] `research/ecc2k130_rho_audit_20260925/README.md`.
[188] `ecc2k130/aws/README.md`.
[189] `docs/ecc2k130-status/README.md`.
[190] `scripts/rho_status/README.md`.
[191] `ecc2k130/aws/README.md`.
[192] `ecc2k130/aws/ACCOUNT-HOLD.md`.
[193] `ecc2k130/README.md`, "Collecting for the campaign from Modal".
[194] `research/ecc2k130_rho_audit_20260925/live_status_20260925T050509Z.json`.
[195] `paper/ecc2k130/data/status_20261010T154157Z.json`.
[196] `research/ecc2k130_rho_audit_20260925/README.md`.

Table 15: Campaign state at the audited snapshot of 2026-09-25 05:05 UTC and at the published feed of 2026-10-10 15:42 UTC. The pooled iterations-per-point ratio is below $2^{28.41}$, partly because the corpus still holds weight-34 records from the first two slots; the mean length of walks that ended by 2026-09-25 is $2^{28.34}$. Sustained production peaked at about 842,000 points per hour on 2026-09-23, about 83 billion iterations/s.

	2026-09-25	2026-10-10
distinguished points stored	367,123,410	485,528,850
iterations (checkpointed)	$2^{56.38}$	$2^{56.68}$
share of expected work	4.4%	5.4%
collisions	0	0
duplicate re-reports dropped	9,953,494	14,153,833
slots / walking / off-weight	195 / 2 / 7	227 / 0 / 7
points in the last 24 h	741,048	0
walk rate over the last hour	3.65 billion iterations/s	0
last point stored	—	2026-10-07 14:41

its measurement, so that anyone who has the same idea later finds a number instead of folklore. None of them changed the campaign.

11.1 Index calculus on the Koblitz curve

Index calculus on $E(\mathbb{F}_{2^n})$ decomposes a random point into m factor-base points through Semaev's summation polynomials [12, 15, 16, 18, 25, 27]; on a Koblitz curve the factor base can be taken Frobenius-stable so that columns are orbits, saving a factor n in relations and n^2 in linear algebra against rho's $\sqrt{2n}$. Two structural facts about $n = 131$ come first. In a normal basis the Frobenius is a coordinate permutation, so a Frobenius-stable subspace is an $\mathbb{F}_2[t]/(t^n - 1)$-submodule, a binary cyclic code of length n, and at $n = 131$ (and $n = 163$) 2 is primitive modulo n, so $t^n - 1$ has exactly two factors and the only stable subspaces have dimension $0, 1, 130, 131$. The usual subspace construction is empty at exactly the interesting sizes; forced onto the 130-dimensional subspace, the orbit trick is a net loss of 57–96 bits for $m \in \{2, \ldots, 5\}$.[197][198] The Couveignes–Lercier elliptic-period alternative needs an auxiliary curve over $\mathbb{F}_2$ with $n \mid \#E'(\mathbb{F}_2)$, and Hasse gives at most 5.[199] What survives is a weight-bounded base $\{R : \mathrm{HW}(x_R) \le w\}$ in the normal basis, which is Frobenius-stable for every n, is the predicate the walk already computes, and is not a low-degree algebraic condition, so only a solver that does not need linearity can use it.

SAT decomposition. Chaining Semaev's S_3 through the intermediate sums, with squaring free, encodes a k-point decomposition as a CNF whose multiplications cost the generated Karatsuba circuit's gates (15,588 at $n = 131$ against 2.2 million for the definition). With $k = 3$, $w = 3$ and CryptoMiniSat the median solve is 0.11 s at $n = 9$ and 2.64 s at $n = 11$; at $n = 23$ no instance finished, one running 25 minutes without returning: roughly $2^{2.3}$ per field bit over that range, from three points.[200]

The compact-orbit ladder. A separate line of work solves rungs of the same curve family ($a = 0$, the ECC2K-130 equation) with a four-summand decomposition, at $n = 41$ and 53 over 85- and 220-column bases and at $n = 61, 71, 73$ over a 600-column base, fully charged, and fits the rank cost. Table 16 is the measured cost and its extrapolation to $n = 131$ under the fit

[197] `RESEARCH_KOBLITZ_INDEX_CALCULUS.md`.
[198] `autoresearcher:ledger/evidence/EV-FROB-d336b0.yaml`.
[199] `RESEARCH_KOBLITZ_INDEX_CALCULUS.md`.
[200] `ecc2k130/README.md, "Index calculus: SAT point decomposition"`.

Table 16: Four-summand compact-orbit index calculus on the ECC2K-130 curve family, single thread, $K = 600$ columns, precompute fully charged (left), and the extrapolation to $n = 131$ ($r = 6.8 \cdot 10^{38}$) at $1.85 \cdot 10^6$ probes/s (right). The minimum base for one expected four-tuple per point is $B > r^{1/4} = 5.1 \cdot 10^9$ points, $K \geq 2 \cdot 10^7$.

n	r (bits)	rank wall	probes/relation
61	47.2	13.1 s	$\sim 4 \cdot 10^4$
71	52.3	1,485 s	$\sim 4.6 \cdot 10^6$
73	56.3	18,398 s	$5.7 \cdot 10^7$

K	probes/relation	total probes	core-years
600	$1.1 \cdot 10^{29}$	$6.6 \cdot 10^{31}$	$1.1 \cdot 10^{18}$
10^6	$4.0 \cdot 10^{22}$	$4.0 \cdot 10^{28}$	$6.8 \cdot 10^{14}$
10^9	$4.0 \cdot 10^{16}$	$4.0 \cdot 10^{25}$	$6.8 \cdot 10^{11}$
10^{12}	$4.0 \cdot 10^{10}$	$4.0 \cdot 10^{22}$	$6.8 \cdot 10^8$

probes/relation $\approx C\, r/(n^2K^2)$ with $C = 1$.[201] The fitted C (0.33 at $n = 61$, 1.51 at $n = 71$, 1.27 at $n = 73$, recomputed here from the exact subgroup orders) disagrees with the structural model's 0.25 by a factor of 1.3 to 6, and the note records the gap as open; the extrapolation uses $C = 1$, between the structural 0.25 and the fitted 1.3–1.5 of the two largest rungs.

Put in the same unit as the rest of the paper, the verdict is clear. Rho at $2^{60.9}$ iterations on one RTX PRO 6000 is about five GPU-years at the campaign's 14.11 billion iterations/s. Four-summand index calculus has total work about $r/(n^2K)$ probes: at $K = 10^9$ that is $4 \cdot 10^{25}$, some $2 \cdot 10^7$ times rho's iteration count with one probe counted as one step (uncalibrated), and the base at which the precompute alone equals rho is $K \approx 1.8 \cdot 10^{16}$ columns, beyond any linear algebra contemplated. The rungs that beat rho do so only in the online class after a precompute that is excluded from the clock (at $n = 73$, 18,400 s of precompute against 46 s of rho online, a 400× total-work deficit traded for a 185× exploratory online wall ratio on one frozen target, on a shared host), and with the precompute charged the method spends 26–1,200× more probes than one rho solve takes steps on every rung, again uncalibrated. Beating rho on total work needs a relation-shape change (five- or six-summand relations, whose per-point yield scales as $B^5/(120r)$), not engineering, and that oracle is unmeasured.[202] In this repository's boundary ledger the Koblitz rows at a 39-bit subgroup run from $S = \text{ops}/\sqrt{r} = 58.8$ (300× signed-Frobenius rho) for the plain three-summand meet-in-the-middle oracle down to 5.12 (26×; 5.92 and 30× on re-measurement) for a balanced two-summand base; the secondary complete-CPU panel on disjoint public points at $n = 37, 41, 53$ has rho ahead in every cell.[203][204]

11.2 Point decomposition against the per-call budget

The sibling library prices the same question from the other end: given rho's $2^{60.81}$ orbit-walk iterations, how fast must one m-summand decomposition be for index calculus to fit inside that budget, and how fast is the best one measured? With a base of 2^ℓ points, $m = 4$ at $\ell = 29$ needs $2^{48.6}$ decompositions and $2^{60.0}$ of linear algebra, leaving 2^{12} rho-iterations per decomposition; $m = 5$ at $\ell = 28$ leaves 2^{33}; $m = 6$ at $\ell = 24$ leaves 2^{37}; $m = 3$ has no budget at all because the linear algebra alone exceeds rho. The best measured decomposition is the non-algebraic meet-in-the-middle at exponent $\lceil m/2 \rceil$ in ℓ, and extrapolated to $n = 131$ it is 2^{58}, 2^{84} and 2^{72} for $m = 4, 5, 6$: 35–51 bits over the budget. Algebraic solvers land far higher: SAT fits at 2^4 ($m = 3$) to 2^7 ($m = 4$) per unit of ℓ, msolve grows faster still, and WDSat at about 2^3, the exhaustive-search exponent. An attack needs a decomposition about 2^{35}–2^{50} times faster than meet-in-the-middle at $\ell \approx 25$–30, which is the obstruction that stops Wagner's k-tree from applying to elliptic curves; the trace-homomorphism clause that halves UNSAT conflicts is a

[201] `RESEARCH_ECC2K130_IC_FEASIBILITY.md`.
[202] `RESEARCH_ECC2K130_IC_FEASIBILITY.md, Ãğ3-4`.
[203] `research/notes/index-calculus/RESEARCH_IC_BOUNDARY_LEDGER.md`.
[204] `docs/ic/BOUNDARY_TARGETS.md`.

constant, not an exponent.[205] A Riemann–Roch (Nagao) oracle on the real curve was measured at factor-base dimensions 4–8 and its derived product law (relations × targets × oracle = $m \cdot 2^{131}$) leaves even a free oracle above rho at $m = 3$ ($2^{68.6}$) and below it only from $m = 4$ ($2^{56.4}$, leaving $2^{4.4}$ of headroom for the oracle itself), where no measured oracle comes close.[206]

11.3 What the negatives say

We carried each alternative through to a measurement, and each landed above rho by a margin that is a matter of exponent, not constant. For ECC2K-130 the honest summary is that the generic-group floor, $\sqrt{\pi\ell/(2 \cdot 262)}$ class-walk steps, is still what the campaign is walking toward, and the only thing this work has managed to move is the cost of one step.

12 Related work

The 2009 attempt. Bailey et al. [3] fixed the iteration function this campaign walks, $R \mapsto \sigma^j(R) + R$ with j from the weight of x, the weight-34 distinguished-point rule, and the $2^{60.9}$ budget, and reported per-platform rates on Core 2 (533 cycles per iteration with 128-bit vectors), Cell, GPUs, FPGAs [14] and ASIC estimates; their SHARCS paper [2] priced the whole Certicom ECC2 list. Bos, Kleinjung, Niederhagen and Schwabe's Cell implementation [9] is the bitsliced lineage this client's CPU and first GPU backends belong to. The type-II optimal-polynomial-basis multiplication of Bernstein and Lange [5] is used verbatim; the conversion networks generated here match their hand-designed chains to within a few instructions (Section 4.1). Bernstein's bit operation counts for binary multiplication [4] are the reference the three-input-logic finding is measured against. Bernstein et al.'s later FPGA designs [7], which set the current size record for a completed binary-curve computation by solving a $2^{117.35}$-order instance on sect113r2 and were extrapolated to a 127-bit field, are the calibration for the pre-board estimate of Section 9, which the measurement then met. Harley's group solved ECC2K-95 in 1998 and ECC2K-108 in April 2000, the latter with about 1,300 volunteers' machines over four months [19, 20]; those two are the only Koblitz challenges completed, and their walks are the ancestors of the one in Section 3.1.

Rho on automorphism classes. The $\sqrt{2m}$ saving from Frobenius and negation on Koblitz curves is due to Wiener and Zuccherato [30] and Gallant, Lambert and Vanstone [17], generalised by Duursma, Gaudry and Morain [13]. Teske's r-adding walks [28] and the Bernstein–Lange–Schwabe treatment of fruitless cycles under the negation map [6] are the background to Section 3.2; the cycle classes measured there are the τ-relation analogue, and the measured walk constants of Table 1 are, to our knowledge, the first reported for this branch distribution on this family. The distinguished-point method is van Oorschot and Wiener's [29]. The 112-bit prime-field record of Bos et al. [10] is the nearest completed computation in scale.

Index calculus on binary curves. Semaev's summation polynomials [27], Gaudry's and Diem's index calculus [12, 18], the Faugère–Perret–Petit–Renault and Petit–Quisquater analyses of Weil-descent systems [15, 25] and Galbraith and Gebregiyorgis's characteristic-two algorithms [16] are the methods Section 11 prices on this curve. The structural closure at $n = 131$ (no Frobenius-stable subspace of intermediate dimension) is elementary once the normal basis is in view, and the measured ladder confirms that the surviving weight-bounded bases do not reach the budget.

[205] `cryptanalysis:experiments/pdp-scaling/README.md`.
[206] `autoresearcher:ledger/evidence/EV-ICPERF-10c5fc.yaml`.

Measurement discipline. The companion paper [1] states the boundary-unit-table-class rule and applies it across rho, baby-step giant-step, kangaroo and prime-field index calculus; this paper is, in effect, its ECC2K-130 chapter at full length.

Prime-field rho on GPUs. Bos et al.'s 112-bit record on PlayStation 3 consoles [10] is the nearest completed prime-field computation in scale. Our NIST walk (Section 7) reuses the standard ingredients, an r-adding walk [28], the negation map with fruitless-cycle handling [6] and Montgomery's simultaneous inversion [24]; what it adds is a measured account of which GPU optimisations from the binary campaign carry over to it.

13 Conclusion

We can summarise what this work established in four points.

First, ECC2K-130 is an arithmetic problem at a known exponent, and nothing we tried moved the exponent. Index calculus on the curve, priced end to end with four-summand relations, costs 10^7 times as much as rho at the challenge size. The best measured decomposition is 35–51 bits short of its per-call budget, and the Frobenius-stable subspaces that the standard construction needs do not exist at $n = 131$. The target is still $\sqrt{\pi\ell/(2 \cdot 262)}$ class steps.

Second, we measured the cost of a GPU step against a floor we wrote down first. Sixteen paired steps took one RTX PRO 6000 from 0.85 to 14.64 billion complete iterations per second on the campaign's σ-walk; later σ-walk builds reached 15.88, and a table walk reached 20.08, as a rate. The roofline of that build has the logic pipe 91% busy and the carry-less unit 73%. For any walk that performs one affine addition per step, 28 billion iterations/s on one card is out of reach on both pipes, and 30 needs two cards. Our own 17.0 billion iterations/s target, declared in advance, rejected a 16.56 billion iterations/s result, which is exactly what a declared target is for.

The same ladder carried over to prime fields better than we expected, though not in the same proportions. On NIST P-256 and P-384, on the same card, explicit carry chains, a wider shared inversion and the same refusal of register-cap trades took the rho walk from 1.075 to 1.632 billion iterations/s and from 0.210 to 0.548, gains of 1.52× and 2.61×. The batch width, a modest knob on the binary walk, was the biggest lever on the prime one, because a Fermat inversion is so much more expensive there. The rest of the GPU arithmetic in the repositories is verified and statically accounted to the same standard but, apart from F4 elimination on rented cards, has not yet run on a device, and we have not quoted its emulations as rates.

Third, the step count is measured, not assumed. The campaign's σ-walk needs $2^{60.91}$–$2^{60.92}$ iterations, which agrees with the 2009 estimate to its own precision. The table walk's cheaper constant was paid back several times over by fruitless cycles until the cycle rule was fixed, and its projected 0.81–0.86 relative cost per solve still awaits the paired run that would confirm it. An FPGA engine built from the same model measured 8.25 billion iterations/s on one F2, against a pre-board central estimate of 8, and is level with the GPU on cost per solve.

Fourth, the campaign's output is a corpus we can stand behind. It holds one report per $2^{28.41}$ iterations at cutoff 32, a figure that replaced an earlier, wrong $2^{27.9}$, and we say so. It contains 486 million points and $2^{56.68}$ iterations with no collision, 5.4% of the expected work. Every record can be re-walked from its seed, and every rate in this paper was re-walked before it was recorded. The fleet that produced most of it was reclaimed on 2026-09-18, the last point landed on 2026-10-07, and collection is paused. Whether the remaining 94.6% ever gets walked is a question of money, not mathematics. What this paper contributes is an honest price.

A Reproduction

All commands run from the repository root unless a directory is named. CUDA rows need the card named in the row; the host checks do not.

Field, walk and solver.

```
cd ecc2k130 && make generate && make test        # 52 checks, GF(2^23..131)
make break-small   # planted logs, GF(2^41)
python3 ecc2k130/examples/rho_toy.py   # the walk on GF(2^23)
```

GPU rates (RTX PRO 6000 unless noted).

```
make -C ecc2k130 bench-rtx-pro6000   # audited sigma preset, 14.64 billion it/s
make -C ecc2k130 audit-rtx-pro6000   # same, with DP34 collection
make -C ecc2k130 gpu-rtx-pro6000-20b   # one-block table walk, 20.08 billion it/s
make -C ecc2k130 gpu-rtx-pro6000-sigma-fused      # 15.44 billion it/s
make -C ecc2k130 gpu-b200-19b   # B200 autosweep arm, 19.40 billion it/s
make -C ecc2k130 bench-local-packed   # RTX PRO 4500 bridge map, 12.50 billion it/s
python3 ecc2k130/benchmark_instance.py   # concurrent-instance accounting
```

Every rate is a paired comparison; the candidate/control pairs, raw samples and re-walk logs are in the `ecc2k130/benchmarks/` directory each note links.

NIST P-256 / P-384 rho (Section 7).

```
make -C gpu/nist test        # field vs Boost, walk, W-stepper cross-check
cargo test --release --lib cryptanalysis::ecdlp_nist   # fifteen-curve CPU solver
cd gpu/nist && make bench ARCH=sm_120 NIST_PTX=1
./bench 256 rho 16 8192      # threads, W, iterations (round 1 best cell)
./bench 256 rho 32 8192      # round 2 best cell; W=32 needs PR 1778
modal run modal_app.py::sweep_rho    # threads x W sweep on Modal
```

Rates, distinguished-point counts and Modal run ids are in `gpu/nist/RESULTS.md`.

Other GPU kernels (host emulation; no device needed).

```
make -C gpu/ecc test        # secp256k1 field, folds, BSGS; ptx_asm_check
make -C gpu/btcpuzzle test  # kangaroo invariant, planted 28/32/36-bit solves
make -C gpu/ecc2k test      # ECC2K-95 field, steppers, pair table, tsan
make -C gpu/semaev test && make -C gpu/semaev bench-host L=7
```

Walk constant and cycles.

```
make -C ecc2k130 test-cycle-rule   # 19,200 tau-cycles refused
# scatter runs and c measurements: ecc2k130/WALK-CONSTANT.md, section 4 and 11.6
```

FPGA.

```
cd hdl/ecc2k130 && python3 ecc2k_ref.py check && make   # vectors, testbenches
make rate   # 6,144 steps, clk/step
cd aws && NENG=128 CLK_MHZ=333 ./build_afi.sh push && ./build_afi.sh launch
```

Campaign.

```
cat ecc2k130/aws/campaign.json   # frozen configuration
ecc2k130/benchmarks/dp-interval/   # 2^28.41 calibration, raw TSV
ecc2k130/CERTIFICATION.md   # storage and replay protocol
research/ecc2k130_rho_audit_20260925/   # live snapshot and audit
```

Alternatives.

```
cd ecc2k130/codegen && \
  python3 indexcalc.py --m 11 --points 3 --weight 3 --trials 5
RESEARCH_ECC2K130_IC_FEASIBILITY.md   # compact-orbit ladder, n=131
cryptanalysis:experiments/pdp-scaling/   # decomposition budget
```

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